GEN Wise LANGUAGE HUB

Chicken soup for the SOUL

sit back in silence, relax and enjoy the interesting journey
you are about to begin as you share in the lives
and stories of some very special people.



Designed by

MR LEO NGUYEN



INTRODUCTION: THE MARVEL FROM CHICKEN SOUP FOR THE SOUL!

It is with great pleasure that we offer this book of "condensed" Chicken Soup for the Soul. We have taken the most popular stories from the series of Chicken Soup for the Soul and condensed them into the essence of each story. Our intention is to provide you with a book that you can easily take with you - in a purse - and that can give you instant deep motivation and fresh inspiration.

Whether you buy this book for yourself or as a gift for a friend and family member, rest assured that you have your hands on a book that will warm the heart, awaken the soul and rekindle the spirit. These stories will touch you at the deepest level and remind you of what is most important about being human.

Recent research indicates that when these stories are read, emotional and spiritual responses are evoked that have positive health benefits. Neurotransmitters are released in the brain to actually accelerate healing in the body and mind. The stories will inspire you to reach out to friends and family with greater love and compassion, will comfort you in times of stress, and will delight you during times of triumph and awake the new things. They encourage you to enthusiastically embrace your dreams and more willingly tackle the obstacles and challenges you will inevitably face in their realization.

We continue to be excited about the consistent feedback we receive through the thousands of calls and letters outlining the significant impact our books have made on readers. We receive 50 to 100 letters a day from people all over the world - Japan, Korea, the Philippines, Cuba, Germany, South Africa and Israel - as well as the United States and Canada, with comments like these:

"I was sent to jail in a 23-hour lock-down unit. I was extremely in the crisis of spirit and thought about suicide. As I was tearing up sheets, Condensed Chicken Soup for the Soul caught my eye and I began to read. As I read, I ran across people in the book that had it much worse than me. It inspired me to stay alive."

- **Pete, prison inmate**

"I lost my dear husband of 46 years recently after more than 20 years living together. The shock and loss were so terrible. My daughter in Las Vegas sent me a copy of Condensed Chicken Soup for the Soul. This book has helped me to no end!"

- **D. E. Naylor, England**

"Though I am only 22, these books have forever left an imprint in my heart. Since I am learning and practicing the lessons taught in Condensed Chicken Soup for the Soul, I feel that the stories can be of greater value to the younger readers. Condensed Chicken Soup for the Soul has taught me of unconditional love, invaluable experience, death, dreams and goals, meanings and purposes of life, and many other things. I have learned to cherish, nourish what I have and never to take what I am offered for granted, one of life's most important lessons. I want to encourage anyone who has yet to read these books to jump on it right now."

- **Heather, Long Island, New York**

So... sit back in silence, relax and enjoy the interesting journey you are about to begin as you share in the lives and stories of some very special people.

If after reading these stories, you are moved to send us some of your personal favorites - either your own or other people - we'll gladly review them for possible inclusion in future volumes of Chicken Soup for the Soul.

Jack Canfield & Mark Victor Hansen

Lưu ý

- Các từ vựng thường có nhiều nghĩa. Chúng mình đã chọn ra nghĩa **phù hợp nhất với bài đọc**. Bạn có thể tìm hiểu thêm các nghĩa khác và cách dùng nếu có thời gian nhé.

Ý nghĩa các chữ viết tắt

n	noun (danh từ)
v	verb (động từ)
adv	adverb (trạng từ)
adj	adjective (tính từ)
prep	preposition (giới từ)
ph.v	phrasal verb (cụm động từ)
SB	somebody (người nào đó)
STh	something (cái gì đó, điều gì đó)

1. LOVE: THE ONE CREATIVE FORCE

A college professor had his sociology class go into the Baltimore slums to get case histories of 200 young boys. They were asked to write an evaluation of each boy's future. In every case the students wrote, "He hasn't got a chance." Twenty-five years later, another sociology professor came across the earlier study. He had his students follow up on the project to see what had happened to these boys. With the exception of 20 boys who had moved away or not contacted, the students learned that 176 of the remaining 180 had achieved more than ordinary success as lawyers, doctors and businessmen. The professor was astounded so he decided to pursue the matter further. Fortunately, all the men were in the area, and he was able to speak to each one. "How do you account for your success?" In each case the reply came with the feeling: "There was a teacher." The teacher was still alive, so he sought her out and asked the old but still alert lady what magic formula she had used to pull these boys out of the slums and into successful achievement. The teacher's eyes sparkled and her lips broke into a gentle smile. "It's really very simple," she said. "I believed those boys." **- Eric Butterworth**	Sociology /ˌsoʊ.siˈɑː.lə.dʒi/ **(n)** xã hội học The slum /slʌm/ **(n)** khu ổ chuột Case history /ˌkeɪs ˈhɪs.tər.i/ **(n)** lý lịch (để nghiên cứu) Evaluation /ɪˌvæl.juˈeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự ước lượng, sự đánh giá Come across (SB/STh) **(ph.v)** tình cờ gặp ai, tình cờ tìm thấy Astounded /əˈstaʊn.dɪd/ **(adj)** vô cùng ngạc nhiên, sửng sốt Pursue /pərˈsuː/ **(v)** tiếp tục, theo đuổi Account for (STh) /əˈkaʊnt/ **(ph.v)** lý giải, giải thích cho Seek (SB/STh) out /siːk/ **(ph.v)** tìm kiếm, cố tìm cho được (v2: sought /sɑːt/) Alert /əˈlɜːrt/ **(adj)** tỉnh táo, lanh lợi
This is where you will win the battle - in the playhouse of your mind. **- Maxwell Maltz** Spread love everywhere you go: First of all in your own house. Give love to your children, to your wife or husband, to a next - door neighbor... Let no one ever come to you without leaving better and happier.	

Be the living expression of God's kindness; kindness in your face, kindness in your eyes, kindness in your smile, kindness in your warm greeting. **- Mother Teresa**	



2. ON COURAGE

A little girl was suffering from a rare and serious disease. Her only chance of recovery appeared to be a blood transfusion from her five-year-old brother, who had miraculously survived the same disease because he had developed the antibodies needed to combat the illness. The doctor explained the situation to her little brother and asked him whether he was ready to transfer blood. He hesitated for only a moment, then took a deep breath and said, "Yes, I'll do it if it will make my sister healthy." As the transfusion progressed, he lay in a bed next to his sister. He smiled as seeing the color returning to her cheeks. Then his face grew pale and his smile faded. He looked up at the doctor and asked with a trembling voice, "Will I start to die right away? Please save my dear sister." Being young, the boy had misunderstood the doctor; he thought he was going to have to give her all his blood. **- Dan Millman**	Blood transfusion /ˈblʌd trænsˌfjuː.ʒən/ **(n)** sự truyền máu Miraculously /məˈræk.jə.ləs.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) kỳ diệu / phi thường Antibody /ˈæn.t̬iˌbɑː.di/ **(n)** kháng thể
Courage is resistance to fear, mastery of fear, not absence of fear. **- Mark Twain**	Resistance /rɪˈzɪs.təns/ **(n)** sự chống lại / kháng cự Mastery /ˈmæs.tər.i/ **(n)** sự kiểm soát, sự tinh thông



3. A BROTHER LIKE THAT!

I once received a beautiful bicycle as a birthday present. One day, when I took a ride on my bicycle in the park, a boy was walking around the bicycle, admiring it. "Is this your bicycle?", he asked. "My brother gave it to me on my birthday", I replied with pride and satisfaction. "Oh, I wish...", he hesitated. Of course I knew what he was going to wish for. He was going to wish he had a brother like that. But what the boy said was unexpected to me: "I wish," the boy went on slowly, "that I could be a brother like that". I saw his face full of determination. Then, he went to the bench behind me, where his little crippled brother was sitting and said: “Someday, I'm gonna give you a wheelchair on your birthday.” **- Dan Clark**	Hesitate /ˈhez.ə.teɪt/ **(v)** ngập ngừng, do dự, lưỡng lự Determination /dɪˌtɜːr.mɪˈneɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự xác định / kiên quyết / quyết tâm Crippled /ˈkrɪp.əld/ **(adj)** què, tàn tật
You will find as you look back upon your life that the moments that stand out, the moments when you have really lived, are the moments when you have done things in the spirit of love. **- Henry Drummond**	Stand out **(ph.v)** nổi bật, gây chú ý



4. TRUE LOVE

Moses Mendelssohn, the grandfather of the well-known German composer, was far from being handsome. Along with a rather short stature, he had a grotesque hunchback. One day, he visited a merchant in Hamburg who had a lovely daughter named Frumtje. Moses fell hopelessly in love with her. But Frumtje was repulsed by his misshapen appearance. When it came time for him to leave, Moses gathered his courage and climbed the stairs to her room to take one last opportunity to speak with her. She was a vision of heavenly beauty, but caused him deep sadness by her refusal to look at him. After several attempts at conversation, Moses shyly asked, "Do you believe marriages are made in heaven?" "Yes," she answered, still looking at the floor. "And do you?" "Yes I do," he replied. "You see, in heaven at the birth of each boy, the Lord announces which girl he will marry. When I was born, my future bride was pointed out to me. Then the Lord added, 'But your wife will be humpbacked. Right then and there I called out, 'Oh Lord, a humpbacked woman would be a tragedy. Please, Lord, give me the hump and let her be beautiful.'" Then Frumtje looked up into his eyes and was stirred by some deep memory. She reached out and gave Mendelssohn her hand and later became his devoted wife. **- Barry and Joyce Vissell**	Grotesque /groʊˈtesk/ **(adj)** kệch cỡm, xấu xí Hunchback /ˈhʌntʃ.bæk/ **(n)** lưng gù, lưng có bướu Repulse /rɪˈpʌls/ **(v)** làm khó chịu, làm thấy ghê, đẩy lùi Misshapen /ˌmɪsˈʃeɪ.pən/ **(adj)** méo mó, chẳng ra hình thù gì Humpbacked /ˈhʌmp.bækt/ **(adj)** gù lưng, có bướu ở lưng Point out **(ph.v)** chỉ ra, nêu ra Stir /stɜːr/ **(v)** làm lay động Devoted /dɪˈvoʊ.ţɪd/ **(adj)** hết lòng, tận tâm, tận tụy

In love the paradox occurs that two beings become one and yet remain two. **- Erich Fromm**	Paradox /ˈper.ə.dɑːks/ **(n)** nghịch lý



5. A SIMPLE GESTURE

Mark was walking home from school one day when he noticed that the boy ahead of him had tripped and dropped all the books he was carrying, along with two sweaters, a baseball bat, a glove and a small tape recorder. Mark knelt down and helped the boy pick up the scattered articles. As they walked, Mark discovered the boy's name was Bill, that he loved video games, baseball and history, that he was having a lot of trouble with his other subjects, and that he had just broken up with his girlfriend. Mark went home after dropping Bill at his house. They continued to see each other around school, had lunch together once or twice, then both graduated from junior high school. They ended up in the same high school, where they had brief contacts over the years. Finally the long-awaited senior year came. Three weeks before graduation, Bill asked Mark if they could talk. Bill reminded him of the day years ago when they had first met. "Do you ever wonder why I was carrying so many things home that day?" asked Bill. "You see, I cleaned out my locker because I didn't want to leave a mess for anyone else. I had stored away some of my mother's sleeping pills and I was going home to commit suicide. But after we spent some time together talking and laughing, I realized that if I had killed myself, I would have missed that memorable moment and so many others that might follow. So you see, Mark, when you picked up my books that day, you did a lot more. You saved my life."	Tape recorder /ˈteɪp rɪˌkɔːr.dər/ **(n)** máy ghi âm Scattered /ˈskæţ.ərd/ **(adj)** rải rác, vương vãi Article /ˈɑːr.ţɪ.kəl/ **(n)** đồ, món đồ Brief contacts /briːf/ - /ˈkɑːn.tækt/ những cuộc tiếp xúc / giao tiếp ngắn ngủi Long-awaited /ˌlɑːŋ.əˈweɪt.ɪd/ **(adj)** chờ đợi đã lâu Clean out **(ph.v)** dọn sạch (không chừa lại gì) *Clean up: dọn dẹp, dọn vệ sinh Store away **(ph.v)** cất, tích trữ

- John W. Schlatter	
Everybody can be great. You only need a heart full of grace and a soul generated by love. **- Martin Luther King**	Grace /greɪs/ **(n)** sự khoan dung, vị tha



6. PUPPIES FOR SALE

A little boy appeared under the store owner's sign, "Puppies for Sale." "How much are you going to sell the puppies for?" he asked. The store owner replied, "Anywhere from $30 to $50." "Can I please look at them?," the little boy said hesitantly. The store owner smiled and whistled, and out of the kennel came five teeny, tiny balls of fur. One puppy was lagging considerably behind. Immediately the little boy singled out the lagging, limping puppy and said, "What's wrong with that little dog?" The owner explained that it had no hip socket; it would always be lame. The little boy became excited. "That is the little puppy that I want to buy." The store owner said, "If you really want him, I'll just give him to you. But I know you don't want to buy that little dog." The little boy got quite upset. He looked straight into the store owner's eyes, and said, "I don't want you to give him to me. That little dog is worth every bit as much as all the other dogs and I'll pay full price. In fact, I'll give you $2.37 now, and 50 cents a month until I have him paid for."	Hesitantly /ˈhez.ə.tənt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) do dự, ngập ngừng, lưỡng lự Kennel /ˈken.əl/ **(n)** cũi chó, chuồng chó Teeny /ˈtiː.ni/ **(adj)** nhỏ xíu, bé tí Single out (SB/STh) **(ph.v)** lựa chọn, chọn ra Limping /lɪmpɪŋ/ **(adj)** đi khập khiễng Hip socket /hɪp/ - /ˈsɑː.kɪt/ **(n)** ổ hông Lame /leɪm/ **(adj)** què, khập khiễng A badly twisted, crippled left leg supported by a metal brace - Một cái chân trái tàn tật bị trẹo nặng được nâng đỡ bằng nẹp kim loại

The store owner advised, "You shouldn't buy this little dog. He is never going to be able to run and jump and play with you like the other puppies." To this, the little boy reached down and rolled up his pant leg to reveal a badly twisted, crippled left leg supported by a metal brace. He looked up at the store owner and softly replied, "Well, I don't run so well myself, and the little puppy will need someone who understands!" **- Dan Clark**	



7. HEART SONG

There was a great man who married the woman of his dreams. With their love, they created a little lovely girl. When the little girl was growing up, the great man would hug her and tell her, "I love you, little girl." The little girl would pout and say, "I'm not a little girl anymore." Then the man would laugh and say, "But to me, you'll always be my little girl." The little girl who-was-not-little-anymore decided to leave her home and went into the world. As she learned more about herself, she learned more about the man. One of his strengths was his ability to express his love to his family. It didn't matter where she went in the world, the man would call her and say, "I love you, little girl." The day came when the little girl who-was-not-little-anymore received an unexpected phone call. The great man was damaged. He had had a stroke. He couldn't talk, smile, walk, hug, dance or tell the little girl who-was-not-little-anymore that he loved her. And so she went to the side of the great man. When she walked into the room and saw him, he looked small and not	Pout /paʊt/ **(v)** bĩu môi, trề môi Cherished /ˈtʃer·ɪʃt/ **(adj)** yêu mến, yêu thương, nâng niu Grief /griːf/ **(n)** nỗi đau buồn, nỗi thương tiếc No longer = Not any longer không còn... nữa Comfort /ˈkʌm.fərt/ **(v)** an ủi, dỗ dành

strong at all. He looked at her and tried to speak, but he could not. The little girl did the only thing she could do. She sat next to the great man, and drew her arms around the useless shoulders of her father. Her head on his chest, she thought of many things. She remembered she had always felt protected and cherished by the great man. She felt grief for the loss she was to endure, the words of love that had comforted her. And then she heard from within the man, the beat of his heart. The heart beat on, steadily unconcerned about the damage to the rest of the body. And while she rested there, the magic happened. She heard what she needed to hear. His heart beat out the words that his mouth could no longer say... I love you, little girl... I love you, little girl... and she was comforted. **- Patty Hansen**	



8. AN ACT OF KINDNESS

President Abraham Lincoln often visited hospitals to talk with wounded soldiers during the Civil War. Once, doctors pointed out a young soldier who was near death and Lincoln went over to his bedside. "Is there anything I can do for you now?" asked the president. The soldier obviously didn't recognize Lincoln, and with some effort he was able to whisper, "Would you please write a letter to my mother?" A pen and paper were provided and the president carefully began to write down what the young man was able to say:	Soldier /ˈsoʊl.dʒər/ **(n)** người lính, quân nhân Grieve /griːv/ **(v)** đau buồn, đau lòng Astonished /əˈstɑː.nɪʃt/ **(adj)** ngạc nhiên, kinh ngạc See SB through **(ph.v)** giúp ai vượt qua khó khăn (giúp đỡ hoặc hỗ trợ ai đó suốt giai đoạn khó khăn trong cuộc đời họ) Hushed /hʌʃt/ **(adj)** im lặng, im ắng

"My dearest mother, I was badly hurt while doing my duty. I'm afraid I'm not going to recover. Don't grieve too much for me, please. Kiss Mary and John for me. May God bless you and father." The soldier was too weak to continue, so Lincoln signed the letter for him and added, "Written for your son by Abraham Lincoln." The young man asked to see the note and was astonished when he discovered who had written it. "Are you really the president?" he asked. "Yes, I am," Lincoln replied quietly. Then he asked if there was anything else he could do. "Would you please hold my hand?" the soldier asked. "It will help to see me through to the end." In the hushed room, the tall gaunt president took the soldier's hand in his and spoke warm words of encouragement until death came. - **The Best of Bits & Pieces**	Gaunt /gɑːnt/ **(adj)** gầy, hốc hác



9. HUGGING IS

Hugging is healthy. It helps the immune system, cures depression, reduces stress and induces sleep. It's invigorating, rejuvenating and has no unpleasant side effects. Hugging is nothing less than a miracle drug. Hugging is all natural. It is organic, naturally sweet, no artificial ingredients, non-polluting, environmentally friendly and 100 percent wholesome.	Induce /ɪnˈduːs/ **(v)** gây ra, đem lại Invigorating /ɪnˈvɪg.ər.eɪtɪŋ/ **(adj)** tiếp thêm sinh lực Rejuvenating /rɪˈdʒuː.vən.eɪtɪŋ/ **(adj)** trẻ hóa, làm khỏe lại

Hugging is the ideal gift. Great for any occasion, fun to give and receive, shows you care, comes with its own wrapping and, of course, fully returnable. Hugging is practically perfect. No batteries to wear out, inflation-proof, non-fattening, no monthly payments, theft-proof and nontaxable. Hugging is an underutilized resource with magical powers. When we open our hearts and arms we encourage others to do the same. Think of the people in your life. Are there any words you'd like to say? Are there any hugs you want to share? Are you waiting and hoping someone else will ask first? Please don't wait! Initiate! **- Charles Faraone**	Side effect /ˈsaɪd ɪˌfekt/ **(n)** tác dụng phụ Nothing less than (STh) chính là, không khác gì Wholesome /ˈhoʊl.səm/ **(adj)** lành tính, không độc, lành mạnh Inflation-proof /ɪnˈfleɪ.ʃən - pruːf/ **(adj)** chống lạm phát, không lạm phát Non-fattening /nɑːn - ˈfæţ.ən.ɪŋ/ **(adj)** không gây béo Theft-proof /θeft - pruːf/ **(adj)** chống trộm Underutilized /ˌʌn.dərˈjuː.ţəl.aɪzd/ **(adj)** ít được tận dụng
We need four hugs a day for survival, eight hugs a day for maintenance, and twelve hugs a day for growth. **- Virginia Satir**	Maintenance /ˈmeɪn.tən.əns/ **(n)** (sự) duy trì



10. DO IT NOW!

In a crash course in psychology, the professor gave the assignment to the students: "Within a week, you go to someone you love, and tell them that you love them. They are people that you have never or rarely told such words."

The assignment looked easy. However, almost all the men of the course, who were over 30 years old, found it difficult to carry out because rarely had they expressed their feelings to someone else.

At the beginning of the next class, the professor asked his students to retell their stories. It seemed that he waited for a woman, but an arm of a man raised. He looked so touched. He began his story:

“Five years ago, my father and I had a vicious disagreement and never really resolved it. We avoided seeing each other unless we absolutely had to at family gatherings. Even those times, we hardly spoke. So by the time I got home, I had convinced myself I was going to tell my father I loved him.

Just making that decision seemed to lift a heavy load off my chest. During that night, I hardly slept. Next day, I was at my parents' house ringing the doorbell, praying that Dad would answer the door. I was afraid if Mom answered, I would chicken out and tell her instead. But as luck would have it, Dad did answer the door.

‘I didn't waste any time’ - I took one step in the door and said, ‘Dad, I just came over to tell you that please forgive me and I love you.’

It was as if a transformation came over my dad. Before my eyes his face softened, the wrinkles seemed to disappear and he began to cry. He reached out and hugged me and said, ‘I love you too, son, but I've never been able to say it.’

But that's not even my point. Two days after that visit, my dad had a sudden heart attack and now is still in the hospital. If I am still hesitating about talking to my father, I may not have no chance to do so.”

- Dennis E. Mannering

Crash course /ˈkræʃ ˌkɔːrs/ **(n)** khóa học cấp tốc

Touched /tʌtʃt/ **(adj)** xúc động

Vicious /ˈvɪʃ.əs/ **(adj)** nghiêm trọng, dữ dội

Chicken out **(ph.v)** từ bỏ, bỏ cuộc (quyết định không làm điều gì đó **vì bạn quá sợ**)

As luck would have it - Thật may mắn làm sao, may mắn thay

No man truly has joy unless he lives in love. **- St. Thomas Aquinas** You must give time to your fellow men - even if it's a little thing. **- Albert Schweitzer**	



11. THE MOST CARING CHILD

Author and lecturer Leo Buscaglia once talked about a contest he was asked to judge. The purpose of the contest was to find the most caring child. The winner was a four-year-old child whose next-door neighbor was an elderly gentleman who had recently lost his dear wife. Upon seeing the man cry, the little boy went into the old gentleman's yard, climbed onto his lap, and just sat there. When his mother asked him what he had said to the neighbor, the little boy said, "Nothing, I just helped him cry." **- Ellen Kreidman**	Lecturer /ˈlek.tʃər.ər/ **(n)** giảng viên đại học; diễn giả Climbed onto his lap - leo lên đùi / lòng của ông ấy
Love is everything. It is the key to life, and its influences are those that move the world. **- Ralph Waldo Trine**	



12. COMPASSION IS IN THE EYES

It was a bitter, cold evening in Northern Virginia many years ago. The old man's beard was glazed by winter's frost while he waited for a ride across the swift-flowing river. The wait seemed endless. His body became numb and stiff from the frigid north wind.

He heard the faint, steady rhythm of approaching hooves galloping along the frozen path. Anxiously, he watched as several horsemen rounded the bend. He let the first one pass by without an effort to get his attention. Then another passed by, and another.

Finally, the last rider neared the spot where the old man sat like a snow statue. As this one drew near, the old man caught the rider's eye and said, "Sir, would you mind giving an old man a ride to the other side? There doesn't appear to be a passageway by foot."

Reining his horse, the rider replied, "Sure thing. Hop aboard." Seeing the old man was unable to lift his half-frozen body from the ground, the horseman dismounted and helped the old man onto the horse. The horseman took the old man not just across the river, but to his destination, which was just a few miles away.

As they neared the tiny but cozy cottage, the horseman's curiosity caused him to inquire, "Sir, I notice that you let several other riders pass by without making an effort to secure a ride. I'm curious why, on such a bitter winter night, you would wait and ask the last rider. What if I had refused and left you there?"

The old man lowered himself slowly down from the horse, looked the rider straight in the eyes, and replied, "I've been around here for some time. I reckon I know people pretty good." The old-timer continued, "I looked into the eyes of the other riders and immediately saw there was no concern for my situation. It would have been useless even to ask them for a ride. But when I looked into your eyes, kindness and compassion were evident. I knew, then and there, that your gentle spirit would welcome the opportunity to give me assistance in my time of need."

Those heartwarming comments touched the horseman deeply. "I'm most grateful for what you have said," he told the

Bitter /ˈbɪt̬.ər/ **(adj)** rét buốt (thời tiết, gió)

Glaze /gleɪz/ **(v)** phủ băng

Swift-flowing /swɪft/ - /ˈfloʊ.ɪŋ/ **(adj)** chảy xiết

Numb /nʌm/ **(adj)** and stiff /stɪf/ **(adj)** tê cóng và cứng đờ

Frigid /ˈfrɪdʒ.ɪd/ **(adj)** giá lạnh, lạnh lẽo

Hoof /huːf/ **(n)** vó ngựa (số nhiều: hooves /huːvz/)

Gallop /ˈgæl.əp/ **(v)** phi nước đại

Rein /reɪn/ **(v)** ghì cương ngựa

Dismount /dɪˈsmaʊnt/ **(v)** xuống ngựa

Reckon /ˈrek.ən/ **(v)** cho là, đoán,= là

Old-timer /ˈoʊldˌtaɪ.mər/ **(n)** người kỳ cựu (một ông già / một người đã ở hoặc làm việc tại một nơi trong một thời gian dài)

Then and there = immediately - ngay lập tức, ngay lúc ấy

Heartwarming /ˈhɑːrtˌwɔːr.mɪŋ/ **(adj)** ấm lòng, chân tình

old man. "May I never get too busy in my own affairs that I fail to respond to the needs of others with kindness and compassion." With that, Thomas Jefferson turned his horse around and made his way back to the White House. **- Anonymous** **From Brian Cavanaugh's The Sower's Seeds**	
Dignity and humility are the cornerstones of compassion. - **Theodore Isaac Rubin**	Dignity /ˈdɪg.nə.ţi/ **(n)** phẩm giá, lòng tự trọng Humility /hjuːˈmɪl.ə.ţi/ **(n)** sự khiêm tốn Cornerstone /ˈkɔːr.nər.stoʊn/ **(n)** nền tảng



13. THE GENTLEST NEED

At least once a day our old black cat comes to one of us in a way that we've all come to see as a special request. It does not mean he wants to be fed, or to be let out. His need is for something very different. If you have a lap handy, he'll jump into it. Once in it, he begins to vibrate almost before you stroke his back, scratch his chin, and tell him over and over what a good kitty he is. Our daughter puts it simply: "Blackie needs to be purred." Blackie isn't the only one who has that need: I share it, and so does my wife. Still, I associate it especially with youngsters, with their quick, impulsive need for a hug, a warm	Vibrate /ˈvaɪ.breɪt/ **(v)** lúc lắc, rung (mình) lên Stroke /stroʊk/ **(v)** vuốt ve Scratch /skrætʃ/ **(v)** cào, gãi Over and over **(adv)** lặp đi lặp lại Purr /pɜːr/ **(n,v)** gầm gừ (tiếng rừ...ừ… của mèo khi thích thú). Nghĩa bóng: âu yếm

lap, and a hand held out - such gestures requiring only a little time. If I could do just one thing, it would be this: To guarantee every child, everywhere, one good purring every day. Kids, like cats, need time to purr. **- Fred T. Wilhelms**	Youngster /ˈjʌŋ.stər/ **(n)** người trẻ tuổi, thanh niên, đứa trẻ Impulsive /ɪmˈpʌl.sɪv/ **(adj)** thôi thúc, bất chợt; bốc đồng
Give what you have to someone. It may be better than you dare to think. **- Henry Wadsworth Longfellow**	



14. THE GIFT

Bennet Cerf relates this touching story about a bus that was bumping along a back road: In one seat a wispy old man sat holding a bunch of fresh flowers. Across the aisle was a young girl whose eyes came back again and again to the man's flowers. The time came for the old man to get off. Impulsively he thrust the flowers into the girl's lap. "I can see you love the flowers," he explained, "and I think my wife would like for you to have them," I'll tell her I gave them to you." The girl accepted the flowers, then watched the old man get off the bus and walk through the gate of a small cemetery. **- Bennet Cerf**	Relate /rɪˈleɪt/ **(v)** kể lại, thuật lại Wispy /ˈwɪs.pi/ **(adj)** mỏng manh, mảnh khảnh Aisle /aɪl/ **(n)** lối đi Get off **(ph.v)** rời đi, xuống xe Impulsively /ɪmˈpʌl.sɪv.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) thôi thúc, bất chợt Thrust /θrʌst/ **(v)** ấn mạnh, nhét, giúi cái gì vào tay ai Cemetery /ˈsem.ə.ter.i/ **(n)** nghĩa trang



15. TWO BROTHERS

Two brothers worked together on the family farm. One was married and had a large family. The other was single. At the day's end, the brothers shared everything equally, produce and profit.

Then one day, the single brother said to himself, "It's not right that we should share equally the produce and the profit. I'm alone and my needs are simple." So each night he took a sack of grain from his bin and crept across the field between their houses, dumping it into his brother's bin.

Meanwhile, the married brother said to himself, "It's not right that we should share the produce and the profit equally. After all, I'm married and I have my wife and my children to look after me in years to come. My brother has no one, and no one to take care of his future." So each night he took a sack of grain and dumped it into his single brother's bin.

Both men were puzzled for years because their supply of grain never dwindled. Then one dark night the two brothers bumped into each other. Slowly it dawned on them what was happening. They dropped their sacks and embraced one another...

- Source Unknown

From Brian Cavanaugh's More Sower's Seeds

Creep /kriːp/ **(v)** lẻn, lén, đi rón rén (v2: crept /krept/)

Puzzled /ˈpʌz.əld/ **(adj)** lúng túng, bối rối

Dwindle /ˈdwɪn.dəl/ **(v)** giảm bớt, vơi đi

Bump /bʌmp/ **(v)** va, đụng, đâm sầm vào

Dawn on/upon /dɑːn/ **(ph.v)** bắt đầu lóe ra, hiện ra trong trí
It dawned on them - họ đã nhận ra



16. FIFTEEN CENTS

When an ice cream sundae cost much less, a boy entered a coffee shop and sat at a table. A waitress put a glass of water in front of him. "How much is an ice cream sundae?" "Fifty cents," replied the waitress. The little boy pulled his hand out of his pocket and studied a number of coins in it. "How much is a dish of plain ice cream?" he inquired. Some people were now waiting for a table, and the waitress was impatient. "Thirty-five cents," she said brusquely. The little boy again counted the coins. "I'll have the plain ice cream." The waitress brought the ice cream and walked away. The boy finished, paid the cashier, and departed. When the waitress came back, she swallowed hard at what she saw. There, placed neatly beside the empty dish, fifteen cents - her tip. - **The Best of Bits & Pieces**	Sundae /ˈsʌn.deɪ/ **(n)** kem mứt, một món kem ăn cùng với trái cây, hạt, xi-rô… Plain /pleɪn/ **(adj)** thường, đơn giản (không trang trí theo bất kỳ cách nào, không thêm gì vào) Brusquely /ˈbrʌsk.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) cộc cằn, lỗ mãng
Life in abundance comes only through great love. - **Elbert Hubbard**	Abundance /əˈbʌn.dəns/ **(n)** sung túc, giàu có



17. BE YOURSELF

You do not have to be your mother unless she is who you want to be. You do not have to be your mother's mother, or your mother's mother's mother, or even your grandmother's mother on your father's side. You may inherit their chins or their shapes or their eyes, but you are not destined to become the women who came before you. You are not destined to live their lives. So if you inherit something, inherit their strength, their resilience. Because the only person you are destined to become is the person you decide to be. - **Pam Finger**	Inherit /ɪnˈher.ɪt/ **(v)** thừa hưởng, thừa kế Resilience /rɪˈzɪl.iəns/ **(n)** tính kiên cường, khả năng mau hồi phục
President Calvin Coolidge once invited friends from his hometown to dine at the White House. Worried about their table manners, the guests decided to do everything that Coolidge did. This strategy succeeded, until coffee was served. The president poured his coffee into the saucer. The guests did the same. Coolidge added sugar and cream. His guests did, too. Then Coolidge bent over and put his saucer on the floor for his cat. - **Erik Oleson**	Dine /daɪn/ **(v)** ăn cơm (bữa chính trong ngày, thường vào buổi tối) Saucer /ˈsɑː.sər/ **(n)** đĩa (đặt dưới chén / tách)
We increase whatever we praise. The whole creation responds to praise, and is glad. **- Charles Fillmore**	Praise /preɪz/ **(v)** ca ngợi, tán dương



18. I LIKE MYSELF NOW

I had a great feeling of relief when I began to understand that a youngster needs more than just subject matter at school. I know mathematics well, and I teach it well. I used to think that was all I needed to do. Now I teach children all subjects, not only math. I accept the fact that I can only succeed partially with some of them. I seemed to have more answers than when I tried to be the expert. The youngster who really made me understand this was Eddie. I asked him one day why he thought he was doing so much better than last year. He gave meaning to my whole new orientation. "It's because I like myself now when I'm with you," he said. **- Everett Shostrom**	Partially /ˈpɑːr.ʃəl.i/ **(adv)** một phần Orientation /ˌɔːr.i.enˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự định hướng



19. START WITH YOURSELF

The following words were written on the tomb of an Anglican bishop in the crypts of Westminster Abbey: When I was young and free, my imagination had no limits, I dreamed of changing the world. As I grew older and wiser, I discovered the world would not change, so I shortened my sights somewhat and decided to change only my country. But it too seemed immovable.	Tomb /tuːm/ **(n)** ngôi mộ Anglican /ˈæŋ.glɪ.kən/ **(adj)** thuộc về Anh giáo Bishop /ˈbɪʃ.əp/ **(n)** giám mục Crypt /krɪpt/ **(n)** hầm mộ (ở bên dưới nhà thờ hoặc tòa nhà khác; thời xưa)

As I grew into my twilight years, in one last desperate attempt, I settled for changing only family, those closest to me, but, they would have none of it. And now as I lay on my deathbed, I suddenly realize: If I had only changed myself first, then by example I would have changed my family. From their inspiration and encouragement, I would then have been able to better my country and, who knows, I may have even changed the world. **- Anonymous**	Abbey /ˈæb.i/ **(n)** tu viện Somewhat /ˈsʌm.wɑːt/ **(adv)** một phần, một chút Immovable /ɪˈmuː.və.bəl/ **(adj)** không lay chuyển được Twilight /ˈtwaɪ.laɪt/ **(adj)** hoàng hôn, xế chiều
For of all sad words of tongue or pen, the saddest are these: "It might have been!" **- John Greenleaf Whittier**	



20. NOTHING BUT THE TRUTH!

David Casstevens of the Dallas Morning News tells a story about Frank Szymanski, a Notre Dame center in the 1940s, who had been called as a witness in a civil suit at South Bend. "Are you on the Notre Dame football team this year?" the judge asked. "Yes, Your Honor." "What position?" "Center, Your Honor." "How good a center?" Szymanski squirmed in his seat, but said firmly:	Center /ˈsen.ʈər/ **(n)** tiền vệ trung tâm (bóng bầu dục Mỹ) Civil suit /ˈsɪv.əl/ - /suːt/ **(n)** vụ kiện dân sự Football = American Football: bóng bầu dục Squirm /skwɜːrm/ **(v)** vặn vẹo, cảm thấy lúng túng Courtroom /ˈkɔːrt.ruːm/ **(n)** phòng xử án

"Sir, I'm the best center Notre Dame has ever had." Coach Frank Leahy, who was in the courtroom, was surprised. Szymanski always had been modest and unassuming. So when the proceedings were over, he took Szymanski aside and asked why he had made such a statement. Szymanski blushed. "I hated to do it, Coach," he said. "But, after all, I was under oath." **- David Casstevens**	Modest /ˈmɑː.dɪst/ **(adj)** khiêm tốn, nhún nhường Unassuming /ˌʌn.əˈsuː.mɪŋ/ **(adj)** không kể công, không tự phụ Proceeding /proʊˈsiː.dɪŋ/ **(n)** vụ kiện tụng, việc tố tụng Blush /blʌʃ/ **(v)** đỏ mặt Oath /oʊθ/ **(n)** lời thề, lời tuyên thệ (trước tòa)
The truth simply is, that's all. It doesn't need reasons; it doesn't have to be right: It's just the truth. **- Carl Frederick**	



21. YOU ARE A MARVEL

Each second we live is a new and unique moment of the universe that will never be again... And what do we teach our children? That two and two make four, and that Paris is the capital of France. We should say to each of them: Do you know what you are? You are a marvel. You are unique. In all the years that have passed, there has never been another child like you. Your legs, your arms, your clever fingers, the way you move. You may become a Shakespeare, a Michelangelo, a Beethoven, you have the capacity for anything. Yes, you are a marvel. And when you grow up, can you then harm another who is, like you, a marvel?	Two and two make four - 2+2=4 Marvel /ˈmɑːr.vəl/ **(n)** điều kỳ diệu / tuyệt vời / khác thường Capacity (for STh) /kəˈpæs.ə.ţi/ **(n)** khả năng hiểu / tạo ra / học cái gì

We must all work to make the world worthy of its children. **- Pablo Casals**	
What we sincerely believe regarding ourselves is true for us. **- Orison Swett Marden** If you treat an individual as if he were what he ought to be and could be, he will become what he ought to be and could be. **- Johann Wolfgang von Goethe**	Regarding /rɪˈgɑːr.dɪŋ/ **(prep)** về, đối với



22. TOMMY'S ESSAY

Soon Tommy's parents, who had recently separated, would arrive for a conference on his failing schoolwork and disruptive behavior. Neither parent knew that I had summoned the other. Tommy, an only child, had always been happy, cooperative, and an excellent student. How could I convince his father and mother that his recent failing grades represented a brokenhearted child's reaction to his adored parents' separation and pending divorce? Tommy's mother entered and took one of the chairs I had placed near my desk. Then the father arrived. They pointedly ignored each other. As I gave a detailed account of Tommy's behavior and schoolwork, I prayed for the right words to bring these two together to help them see what they were doing to their son.	Disruptive /dɪsˈrʌp.tɪv/ **(adj)** gây rối Summon /ˈsʌm.ən/ **(v)** gọi đến, mời đến Pending /ˈpen.dɪŋ/ **(adj)** chưa giải quyết, đang chờ xử lý Pointedly /ˈpɔɪn.ʈɪd.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) rõ ràng; khó chịu Smudged /smʌdʒd/ **(adj)** bẩn, dơ, bị nhòe, bị ố Crumpled /ˈkrʌm.pəld/ **(adj)** có nhiều nếp gấp, bị nhàu

But somehow the words wouldn't come. Perhaps if they saw one of his smudged, carelessly done papers. I found a crumpled, tear-stained sheet stuffed in the back of his desk. Writing covered both sides, a single sentence scribbled over and over. Silently, I smoothed it out and gave it to Tommy's mother. She read it and then without a word handed it to her husband. He frowned. Then his face softened. He studied the scrawled words for what seemed an eternity. At last, he folded the paper carefully and reached for his wife's out-stretched hand. She wiped the tears from her eyes and smiled up at him. My own eyes were brimming, but neither seemed to notice. In his own way God had given me the words to reunite that family. He had guided me to the sheet of paper covered with the anguished outpouring of a small boy's troubled heart. "Dear Mother... Dear Daddy... I love you... I love you... I love you." **- Jane Lindstrom**	Tear-stained /ˈtɪrˌsteɪnd/ **(adj)** đẫm nước mắt, dính nước mắt Stuff /stʌf/ **(v)** nhét, lèn Scribble /ˈskrɪb.əl/ **(v)** viết vụng về, viết nguệch ngoạc Frown /fraʊn/ **(v)** cau mày, nhăn mặt Scrawl /skrɑːl/ **(v)** viết vụng về, viết nghuệch ngoạc (= scribble) Brim /brɪm/ **(v)** tràn đầy (nước mắt), rưng rưng Anguished /ˈæŋ.gwɪʃt/ **(adj)** đau khổ Outpouring /ˈaʊtˌpɔːr.ɪŋ/ **(n)** sự thổ lộ



23. LITTLE EYES UPON YOU

There are little eyes upon you and they're watching night and day. There are little ears that quickly take in every word you say. There are little hands all eager to do anything you do; and a little boy who's dreaming of the day he'll be like you. You're the little fellow's idol, you're the wisest of the wise.	Eager /ˈiː.gər/ **(adj)** hăng hái, nhiệt tình, khao khát Suspicion /səˈspɪʃ.ən/ **(n)** sự nghi ngờ Devoutly /dɪˈvaʊt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) tận tâm, hết lòng

In his little mind about you no suspicions ever rise. He believes in you devoutly, holds all you say and do; He will say and do, in your way when he's grown up like you. There's a wide-eyed little fellow who believes you're always right, and his eyes are always opened, and he watches day and night. You are setting an example every day in all you do, to grow up to be like you. **- Source Unknown**	



24. WHAT YOU ARE IS AS IMPORTANT AS WHAT YOU DO

It was a sunny Saturday afternoon in Oklahoma City. I and my friend was taking his two little boys to an entertainment club. My friend walked up to the man at the ticket counter and said: "How much is it to get in? I'd like four tickets" The young man replied, "$3.00 for you and $3.00 for any kid who is older than six. We let them in free if they are six or younger. How old are they?" My friend replied, "This boy is seven and the younger one is four, so I guess I owe you $9.00." The man at the ticket counter looked him surprisedly then said: “You could have saved yourself $3.00. You could have told me that the older one was six; I wouldn't have known the difference.”	Ticket counter /ˈtɪk.ɪt/ - /ˈkaʊn.ʈər/ **(n)** quầy bán vé Honesty /ˈɑː.nə.sti/ **(n)** tính trung thực Respect /rɪˈspekt/ **(n)** sự tôn trọng

My friend softly replied: “Yes, that may be true, but the kids would have known the difference. I don't want to sell my honesty and the respect from my children with only $3.00.” **- Patricia Fripp**	
Honesty is the first chapter in the book of wisdom. **- Thomas Jefferson**	



25. THE GIFT OF THE GODS

It was a warm summer day when the gods placed it in her hands. She trembled with a strange emotion as she saw how fragile it appeared. This was a very special gift the gods were entrusting to her. A gift that would one day belong to the world. Until then, they instructed her, she was to be its guardian and protector. The woman said she understood and reverently took it home, determined to live up to the faith the gods had placed in her. At first, she barely let it out of her sight, protecting it from anything she perceived to be harmful to its well-being; watching with fear in her heart when it was exposed to the environment outside of the sheltered cocoon she had formed around it. But the woman began to realize that she could not shelter it forever. It needed to learn to survive the harsh elements in order to grow strong. So with gentle care she gave it more space to grow... enough to allow it to grow wild and untamed. One day, she became aware of how much the gift had changed. It no longer had a look of vulnerability about it. Now it seemed to glow with strength and steadiness, almost as if it	Fragile /ˈfrædʒ.əl/ **(adj)** dễ vỡ yếu ớt, mỏng manh Entrust /ɪnˈtrʌst/ **(v)** giao, giao phó Reverently /ˈrev.ər.ənt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) cung kính Barely /ˈber.li/ **(adv)** cực ít, hầu như không, rất ít khi Perceive /pərˈsiːv/ **(v)** nhận thấy, nhận thức Sheltered /ˈʃel.ʈərd/ **(adj)** được che chở, được bảo vệ Cocoon /kəˈkuːn/ **(n)** cái kén, cái bọc, lớp bọc Harsh /hɑːrʃ/ **(adj)** khắc nghiệt, gay gắt

were developing a power within. Month after month she watched as it became stronger and more powerful. She knew deep within her heart that her time with the gift was nearing an end. The inevitable day arrived when the gods came to take the gift and present it to the world. The woman felt a deep sadness, for she would miss its constant presence in her life. With heartfelt gratitude she thanked the gods for allowing her the privilege of watching over the precious gift for so many years. Straightening her shoulders, she stood proud, knowing that it was, indeed, a very special gift. One that would add to the beauty and essence of the world around it. And the mother let her child go. **- Renee R. Vroman**	Untamed /ʌnˈteɪmd/ **(adj)** không chế ngự, không thuần dưỡng Vulnerability /ˌvʌl.nər.əˈbɪl.ə.ţi/ **(n)** tính chất dễ bị tổn thương Inevitable /ˌɪnˈev.ə.ţə.bəl/ **(adj)** không thể tránh khỏi Heartfelt /ˈhɑːrt.felt/ **(adj)** chân thành, thành tâm Privilege /ˈprɪv.əl.ɪdʒ/ **(n)** đặc quyền, đặc lợi, đặc ân Essence /ˈes.əns/ **(n)** cốt lõi, bản chất



26. WHAT IT MEANS TO BE ADOPTED?

Teacher Debbie Moon's first graders were discussing a picture of a family. One little boy in the picture had different color hair than the other family members. One child suggested that he was adopted and a little girl named Jocelynn Jay said, "I know all about adoptions because I'm adopted." "What does it mean to be adopted?" asked another child. "It means," said proudly Jocelynn, "that you grew in your mother's heart instead of her tummy." **- George Dolan**	Grader /greɪ.dər/ **(n)** học sinh thuộc một cấp lớp nào đó của tiểu học hoặc trung học First graders: những học sinh lớp 1. Adopted /əˈdɑːp.tɪd/ **(adj)** được nhận làm con nuôi Adoption /əˈdɑːp.ʃən/ **(n)** sự nhận hoặc được nhận làm con nuôi



27. MY FATHER

When I Was…

4 years old: My daddy can do anything.

5 years old: My daddy knows a whole lot.

6 years old: My dad is smarter than your dad.

8 years old: My dad doesn't know exactly everything.

10 years old: In the olden days when my dad grew up, things were sure different.

12 years old: Oh, well, naturally, Father doesn't know anything about that. He is too old to remember his childhood.

14 years old: Don't pay any attention to my father. He is so old-fashioned!

21 years old: Him? My Lord, he's hopelessly out-of-date.

25 years old: Dad knows a little bit about it, but then he should because he has been around so long.

30 years old: Maybe we should ask Dad what he thinks. After all, he's had a lot of experience.

35 years old: I'm not doing a single thing until I talk to Dad.

40 years old: I wonder how Dad would have handled it. He was so wise and had a world of experience.

50 years old: I'd give anything if Dad were here now so I could talk this over with him. Too bad I didn't appreciate how smart he was. I could have learned a lot from him.

- **Ann landers**

Olden /ˈoʊl.dən/ **(adj)** xưa, thuở xưa

Naturally /ˈnætʃ.ər.əl.i/ **(adv)** vốn dĩ, dĩ nhiên

Hopelessly /ˈhoʊp.ləs.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) tuyệt vọng, vô vọng

A place is nothing, not even space, unless at its heart a figure stands. - **Amy Lowell**	



28. PACO, COME HOME!

In a small town in Spain, a man named Jorge had a bitter argument with his young son Paco. The next day, Jorge discovered that Paco's bed was empty - he had run away from home. Overcome with remorse, Jorge searched his soul and realized that his son was more important to him than anything else. He wanted to start over. Jorge went to a well-known store in the center of town and posted a large sign that read, "Paco, come home. I love you. Meet me here tomorrow morning." The next morning Jorge went to the store, where he found no less than seven young boys named Paco who had also run away from home. They were all answering the call for love, hoping it was their father inviting them home with open arms. - **Alan Cohen**	Remorse /rɪˈmɔːrs/ **(n)** sự ăn năn, hối hận Start over **(ph.v)** bắt đầu lại



29. IF I HAD MY CHILD TO RAISE OVER AGAIN

If I had my child to raise all over again, I'd finger-paint more, and point the finger less. I would do less correcting and more connecting. I'd take my eyes off my watch, and watch with my eyes. I would care to know less and know to care more. I'd take more hikes and fly more kites. I'd stop playing serious, and seriously play. I would run through more fields and gaze at more stars. I'd do more hugging and less tugging. I would be firm less often, and affirm much more. I'd build self-esteem first, and the house later. I'd teach less about the love of power, And more about the power of love. - **Diane Loomans**	Take my eyes off - lấy mắt khỏi, rời mắt khỏi... Hike /haɪk/ **(n)** đi bộ đường dài Gaze /geɪz/ **(v)** nhìn chằm chằm Tug /tʌg/ **(v)** kéo mạnh, lôi kéo Firm /fɜːrm/ **(adj)** kiên quyết, không thay đổi, cứng rắn Affirm /əˈfɜːrm/ **(v)** khẳng định, xác nhận Self-esteem /ˌself.ɪˈstiːm/ **(n)** lòng tự trọng
There are only two lasting bequests we can hope to give our children. One of these is roots, the other wings. - **Hodding Carter**	Bequest /bɪˈkwest/ **(n)** vật để lại, di vật ; sự truyền lại, sự để lại



30. NO CHARGE

The little boy suddenly came up to his mother and handed her a piece of paper when she was busy in preparing dinner. After his mom dried her hands on an apron, she read it:

For cutting the grass. $5.00

For cleaning up my room this week. $1.00

For going to the store for you. $0.50

Babysitting my kid brother. $0.25

Taking out the garbage. $1.00

For getting a good report card. $5.00

For cleaning up, and raking the yard. $2.00

Total owed: $14.75

After reading, his mother looked at him standing there, expectantly. She picked up the pen, turned the paper over and wrote:

Nine months I carried you while you were inside me: No Charge.

The times I've sat with you, doctored and prayed for you: No Charge.

For all the tears that you've caused through the years: No Charge.

For all the nights that I couldn't sleep because of the worries I knew were ahead: No Charge.

For all the toys, food, clothes, that I gave to you through the years: there's No Charge, son.

And when you add it all up, the full cost of real love is, No Charge.

When the boy finished reading what his mother had written, there were great big old tears in his eyes. He looked straight at his mother and said, "Mom, I sure do love you." And then he took the pen and in great big letters he wrote: "PAID IN FULL."

- M.Adams

Apron /ˈeɪ.prən/ **(n)** tạp dề

Babysitting /ˈbeɪ.biˌsɪt̬.ɪŋ/ **(n)** việc trông chừng em bé

Rake /reɪk/ **(v)** cào (sân)

Expectantly /ɪkˈspek.tənt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) mong đợi, hy vọng

Doctor /ˈdɑːk.tər/ **(v)** chữa bệnh, điều trị

Add it all up - cộng lại tất cả



31. ALMIE ROSE

It was at least two months before Christmas when nine-year-old Almie Rose told her father and me that she wanted a new bicycle. As Christmas drew nearer, her desire for a bicycle seemed to fade, or so we thought. We purchased the latest rage, Baby- Sitter's Club dolls, and a doll house. Then, much to our surprise, on December 23rd, she said that she "really wanted a bike more than anything else." It was just too late, what with all the details of preparing Christmas dinner and buying last-minute gifts, to take the time to select the "right bike" for our little girl. So, here we were - Christmas Eve around 9:00 p.m., with Almie Rose and her six-year-old brother, Dylan, nestled snug in their beds. We could now think only of the bicycle, the guilt, and being parents who would disappoint their child. "What if I make a little bicycle out of clay and write a note that she could trade the clay model in for a real bike?" my husband asked. The theory being that since this is a high-ticket item and she is "such a big girl," it would be much better for her to pick it out. So he spent the next four hours painstakingly working with clay to create a miniature bike. On Christmas morning, we were excited for Almie Rose to open the little heart- shaped package with the beautiful red and white clay bike and the note. Finally, she opened it and read the note aloud. "Does this mean that I trade in this bike that Daddy made me for a real one? "Yes." I said, beaming.	Rage /reɪdʒ/ **(n)** mốt thịnh hành, mốt phổ biến Nestle snug /ˈnes.əl/ - /snʌg/ nép mình yên ấm Clay /kleɪ/ **(n)** đất sét Painstakingly /ˈpeɪnzˌteɪ.kɪŋ.li/ **(adv)** chịu khó, cần cù, cẩn thận Miniature /ˈmɪn.i.ə.tʃər/ **(adj)** nhỏ, thu nhỏ Beam /ˈbiː.mɪŋ/ **(v)** cười (rạng rỡ) Move heaven and earth - làm tất cả mọi thứ, dùng mọi biện pháp

Almie Rose had tears in her eyes when she replied, "I could never trade in this beautiful bicycle that Daddy made me. I'd rather keep this than get a real bike." At that moment, we would have moved heaven and earth to buy her every bicycle on the planet! **- Michelle Lawrence**	



32. THE RULES FOR BEING HUMAN

1. You will receive a body You may like it or hate it, but it will be yours for the entire period. **2. You will be presented with lessons** You are enrolled in a full-time informal school called Life. Each day in this school you will learn lessons. You may like the lessons or think them irrelevant and stupid. **3. There are no mistakes, only lessons** Growth is a process of trial and error: experimentation. The "failed" experiments are as much a part of the process as the experiment that ultimately "works." **4. A lesson is repeated until learned** A lesson will be presented to you in various forms until you have learned it. Once learned, you then go on to the next lesson. **5. Learning lessons does not end** There is no part of life that does not contain its lessons. If you are alive, there are lessons to be learned.	Enroll /ɪnˈrəʊl/ **(v)** ghi danh, kết nạp Experimentation /ɪkˌsper.ə.menˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự thí nghiệm, sự thử nghiệm Ultimately /ˈʌl.tə.mət.li/ **(adv)** cuối cùng Obtain /əbˈteɪn/ **(v)** lấy, đạt được, thu được Merely /ˈmɪr.li/ **(adv)** chỉ, đơn thuần Unravel /ʌnˈræv.əl/ **(v)** làm sáng tỏ Double helix /ˈhiː.lɪks/ **(n)** chuỗi xoắn kép (cấu trúc DNA)

6. "There" is no better than "here" When your "there" has become a "here," you will simply obtain another "there" that will again look better than "here." **7. Others are merely mirrors of you** You cannot love or hate something about another person unless it reflects something you love or hate about yourself. **8. What you make of your life is up to you** You have all the tools and resources you need. What you do with them is up to you. The choice is yours. **9. The answers to Life's questions lie inside you** All you need to do is look, listen and trust. **10. You will forget all of this at birth** You can remember it if you want by unraveling the double helix of inner knowing. - **Cheárie Carter-Scott**	
Success in life isn't a given. It costs attitude, ambition and acceptance. - **Jennifer Leigh Youn**	



33. A SENSE OF GEESE

When you see geese flying along in "V" formation, you might consider what science has discovered as to why they fly that way. As each bird flaps its wings, it creates an uplift for	Formation /fɔːrˈmeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** đội hình

the bird immediately following. By flying in "V" formation, the whole flock adds at least 71 percent greater flying range than if each bird flew on its own. People who share a common direction and sense of community can get where they are going more quickly and easily because they are traveling on the thrust of one another. When a goose falls out of formation, it suddenly feels the drag and resistance of trying to go it alone - and quickly gets back into formation to take advantage of the lifting power of the bird in front. If we have as much sense as a goose, we will stay in formation with those people who are headed the same way we are. When the head goose gets tired, it rotates back in the wing and another goose flies point. It is sensible to take turns doing demanding jobs, whether with people or with geese flying south. Geese honk from behind to encourage those up front to keep up their speed. What messages do we give when we honk behind? Finally - and this is important - when a goose gets sick or is wounded by gunshot, and falls out of formation, two other geese fall out with that goose and follow it down to lend help and protection. They stay with the fallen goose until it is able to fly or until it dies; and only then do they launch out on their own, or with another formation to catch up with their group. If we have the sense of a goose, we will stand by each other like that. **- Source Unknown**	Uplift /ˈʌp.lɪft/ **(n)** sự nâng lên, yếu tố thúc đẩy Flock /flɑːk/ **(n)** bầy, đàn Thrust /θrʌst/ **(n)** sự đẩy mạnh, sức đẩy Drag /dræg/ **(n)** sự kéo lê, sự chậm chạp lề mề, sự cản trở Rotate /ˈroʊ.teɪt/ **(v)** xoay; luân phiên Demanding /dɪˈmæn.dɪŋ/ **(adj)** đòi hỏi khắt khe, đòi hỏi nhiều cố gắng Honk /hɑːŋk/ **(n)** tiếng còi; tiếng kêu của ngỗng trời Launch out /lɑːntʃ/ **(ph.v)** phóng đi, bay đi; bắt đầu việc gì đó mới



34. ADAM

While recuperating from her second open-heart surgery at Children's Hospital of Western Ontario, my six-year-old daughter, Kelley, was moved from the intensive care unit to the floor with the other children. Because a section of the floor was closed, Kelley was put in the wing reserved for cancer patients. In the adjacent room, a six-year-old boy named Adam was fighting a battle with leukemia. Adam stayed at the hospital for a portion of each month while receiving chemotherapy treaments. Every day Adam sauntered into Kelley's room to visit, pushing the pole that held his chemotherapy bag. Despite the discomfort of the treatments, Adam was always smiling and cheerful. He entertained us for hours with his many stories. Adam had a way of finding the positive and the humor in any situation, however difficult. One particular day, I was feeling tired and anxious for Kelley's release from the hospital. The gray, gloomy day outside only fueled my poor mood. While I stood at the window looking at the rainy sky, Adam came in for his daily visit. I commented to him on what a depressing day it was. With his ever-present smile, Adam turned to me and cheerily replied, "Every day is beautiful for me." From that day on I have never had a gloomy day. Even the grayest days bring a feeling of joy as I remember with gratitude the words of wisdom spoken by a very brave six-year-old boy named Adam. **- Patti Merritt**	Recuperate /rɪˈkuː.pər.eɪt/ **(v)** hồi phục, hồi sức Reserve /rɪˈzɜːrv/ **(v)** dành riêng, để dành Adjacent /əˈdʒeɪ.sənt/ **(adj)** gần kề, sát ngay Leukemia /luːˈkiː.mi.ə/ **(n)** bệnh bạch cầu Portion /ˈpoːr.ʃən/ **(n)** phần Chemotherapy /ˌkiː.moʊˈθer.ə.pi/ **(n)** hóa trị liệu Saunter /ˈsɑːn.ʧər/ **(v)** đi (tản bộ) Pole /poʊl/ **(n)** cái sào, cọc (cây treo túi hóa trị) Fuel /ˈfjuː.əl/ **(v)** cung cấp nhiên liệu (fuel my poor mood - làm tăng thêm tâm trạng tồi tệ)
To have character is to be big enough to take life on. **- Mary Caroline Richards**	Character /ˈker.ək.tər/ **(n)** ý chí, nghị lực



35. THE HAND

On the Thanksgiving Day, a school teacher asked her class of first-graders to draw a picture of something they were thankful for. She would know how little these poor children actually had to be thankful for. She thought that most of them would draw pictures of turkeys or tables with food. However, the teacher was taken aback with the picture Douglas handed in a simple childishly drawn hand. But why and whose hand Douglas drew? The class was captivated by the abstract image. "I think it must be the hand of God that brings us food," said one child. "A farmer," said another, "because he grows the turkeys." Finally when the others were at work, the teacher bent over Douglas' desk and asked whose hand it was. "It's your hand, Teacher," he mumbled. She recalled that frequently at recess she had taken Douglas, a reserved lonely child, by the hand. She often did that with the children. But it meant so much to Douglas. Perhaps this was everyone's Thanksgiving, not for the material things given to us but for the chance, in whatever small way, to give to others. **- Source Unknown**	Take aback /teɪk/ - /əˈbæk/ **(ph.v)** sửng sốt, ngạc nhiên (thường đi với cấu trúc to be taken aback - bị làm cho ngạc nhiên) Childishly /ˈtʃaɪl.dɪʃ.li/ **(adv)** như trẻ con Captivate /ˈkæp.tə.veɪt/ **(v)** làm say đắm, quyến rũ Abstract /ˈæb.strækt/ **(adj)** trừu tượng, khó hiểu Mumble /ˈmʌm.bəl/ **(v)** nói lầm bầm Recess /ˈriː.ses/ or /rɪˈses/ **(n)** giờ giải lao, giờ ra chơi chính
When you give yourself, you receive more than you give. **- Antoine de Saint Exupeáâry** In helping others, we shall help ourselves, for whatever good we give out completes the circle and comes back to us. **- Flora Edwards**	



36. THE SECRETS OF HEAVEN AND HELL

The old monk sat by the side of the road. With his eyes closed and his legs crossed and his hand folded in his lap, he sat in deep meditation, he sat.

Suddenly his zazen was interrupted by the harsh and demanding voice of a samurai warrior.

"Old man! Teach me about Heaven and Hell!"

At first, as though he had not heard, there was no perceptible response from the monk. But gradually, he began to open his eyes, the faintest hint of a smile playing around the corners of his mouth as the samurai stood there waiting... impatient... growing more and more agitated with each passing second.

"You would know the secrets of Heaven and Hell?" replied the monk at last. "You who are so unkempt. You whose hands and feet are covered with dirt. You whose hair is uncombed, whose breath is foul, whose sword is all rusty neglected. You would ask me of Heaven and Hell?"

The samurai uttered a vile curse. He drew his sword and raised it high above his head. His face turned to crimson, the veins on his neck stood out in bold relief as he prepared to sever the monk's head from its shoulders.

"That is Hell," said the old monk gently, just as the sword began its descent. In that fraction of a second, the samurai was overcome with amazement, awe, compassion and love for this gentle being who had dared to risk his very life to give him such a teaching. He stopped his sword in mid-flight and his eyes filled with grateful tears.

"And that," said the monk, "is Heaven."

- Father John W. Groff Jr

Zazen /ˈzɑːzen/ **(n)** sự tọa thiền

Perceptible /pərˈsep.tə.bəl/ **(adj)** có thể nhận thấy, có thể cảm giác thấy

Agitated /ˈædʒ.ə.teɪ.ţɪd/ **(adj)** khích động

Unkempt /ʌnˈkempt/ **(adj)** trông có vẻ nhếch nhác, trông có vẻ lôi thôi lếch thếch

Foul /faʊl/ **(adj)** bẩn thỉu, hôi hám, hôi thối

Rusty /ˈrʌs.ti/ **(adj)** bị gỉ, han gỉ, cùn

Neglected /nɪˈglek.tɪd/ **(adj)** bị bỏ quên, bị bỏ bê

Utter /ˈʌ.ţər/ **(adj)** thốt ra

A vile curse /vaɪl/ **(adj)** /kɜːrs/ **(n)** một lời nguyền thấp hèn / ghê tởm

Crimson /ˈkrɪm.zən/ **(n)** đỏ thẫm

Relief /rɪˈliːf/ nổi bật lên, khắc nổi. Bold relief - (đường gân) căng lên, nổi đậm lên

Sever /ˈsev.ər/ **(v)** cắt đứt

Descent /dɪˈsent/ **(n)** sự hạ xuống

Awe /ɑː/ **(n)** sự kính sợ, sự tôn trọng



37. IT'S NEVER TOO LATE

Several years ago, while attending a communications course, I experienced a most unusual teaching process. The instructor asked us to list anything in our past that we felt ashamed of, guilty about, regretted, or incomplete about. The next week he invited participants to read their lists aloud. This seemed like a very private process, but there's always some brave soul in the crowd who will volunteer. As people read their lists, mine grew longer.

After three weeks, I had 101 items on my list. The instructor then suggested that we find ways to make amends, apologize to people, or take some action to right any wrongdoing. I was seriously wondering how this could ever improve my communications, having visions of alienating just about everyone from my life.

The next week, the man next to me raised his hand and volunteered this story: “While making my list, I remembered an incident from high school. I grew up in a small town in Iowa. There was a sheriff in town that none of us kids liked. One night, my two buddies and I decided to play a trick on Sheriff Brown. After drinking a few beers, we found a can of red paint, climbed the public water tank in the middle of town, and wrote, on the tank, in bright red letters: Sheriff Brown is an s.o.b. The next day, the town arose to see our glorious sign. Within two hours, Sheriff Brown had my two pals and me in his office. My friends confessed and I lied, denying the truth. No one ever found out.

Nearly 20 years later, Sheriff Brown's name appears on my list. I didn't even know if he was still alive. Last weekend, I dialed information in my hometown back in Iowa.

Sure enough, there was a Roger Brown still listed. I dialed his number. After a few rings, I heard: “Hello?” I said:

Amends /əˈmendz/ **(n)** sự đền bù, sự bồi thường

Alienate /ˈeɪ.li.ə.neɪt/ **(v)** làm cho xa lánh

Incident /ˈɪn.sɪ.dənt/ **(n)** sự việc, việc tình cờ xảy ra, việc rắc rối

Sheriff /ˈʃer.ɪf/ **(n)** cảnh sát trưởng (Mỹ); người đứng đầu một hạt (Anh)

S.o.b. = Son of a bitch

For your sake /seɪk/ vì bạn, vì lợi ích của bạn

Springboard /ˈsprɪŋ.bɔːrd/ **(n)** sức bật, điểm khởi đầu thúc đẩy cho việc gì đó

Mediator /ˈmiː.di.eɪ.ʈər/ **(n)** người dàn xếp, người hòa giải

Resolution /ˌrez.əˈluː.ʃən/ **(n)** sự giải quyết, sự chuyển hóa

“Sheriff Brown?” Pause. “Yup.” “Well, this is Jimmy Calkins. And I want you to know that I did it.” Pause. “I knew it!” he yelled back. We had a good laugh and a lively discussion. His closing words were: “Jimmy, I always felt badly for you because your buddies got it off their chest, and I knew you were carrying it around all these years. I want to thank you for calling me... for your sake.” Jimmy inspired me to clear up all 101 items on my list. It took me almost two years, but became the springboard and true inspiration for my career as a conflict mediator. No matter how difficult the conflict, crisis or situation, I always remember that it's never too late to clear up the past and begin resolution. **- Marilyn Manning**	
Each experience through which we pass operates for our good. This is a correct attitude to adopt and we must be able to see it in that light. **- Raymond Holliwell**	Adopt /əˈdɑːpt/ **(v)** chọn lấy, sử dụng



38. GREAT VALUE IN DISASTER

Thomas Edison's laboratory was virtually destroyed by fire in December, 1914. Although the damage exceeded two million dollars, the buildings were only insured for $238,000 because they were made of concrete and thought to be fireproof. Much of Edison's life's work went up in spectacular flames that December night. At the height of the fire, Edison's 24-year-old son, Charles, frantically searched for his father among the smoke and debris. He finally found him, calmly watching the scene,	Virtually /ˈvɜːr.tʃu.ə.li/ **(adv)** hầu như, gần như Exceed /ɪkˈsiːd/ **(v)** vượt quá Fireproof /ˈfaɪr.pruːf/ **(adj)** chịu lửa, chống cháy Go up **(ph.v)** bốc lên Spectacular /spekˈtæk.jə.lər/ **(adj)** ngoạn mục, hùng vỹ

his red face glowing in the reflection, his white hair blowing in the wind. "My heart ached for him," said Charles. "He was 67 - no longer a young man to start life when everything was going up in flames. When he saw me, he shouted, 'Charles, where's your mother?' When I told him I didn't know, he said, 'Find her. Bring her here. She will never see anything like this as long as she lives.'" The next morning, Edison looked at the ruins and said, "There is great value in disaster. All our mistakes are burned up. Thank God we can start anew." Three weeks after the fire, Edison managed to deliver his first phonograph. **- From Brian Cavanaugh's The Sower's Seeds**	Frantically /ˈfræn.ʈɪ.kəl.i/ **(adv)** (một cách) điên cuồng, điên rồ Debris /dəˈbriː/ **(n)** mảnh vỡ, mảnh vụn, vôi gạch đổ nát Anew /əˈnuː/ **(adv)** lại, lại nữa, một lần nữa Phonograph /ˈfoʊ.noʊ.græf/ **(n)** máy hát, máy quay đĩa
If your house is on fire, warm yourself by it. **- Spanish Proverb**	



39. GOOD NEWS

Robert De Vincenzo, the great Argentine golfer, once won a tournament and, after receiving the check and smiling for the cameras, he went to the clubhouse and prepared to leave. Some time later, he walked alone to his car in the parking lot and was approached by a young woman. She congratulated him on his victory and then told him that her child was seriously ill and near death. She did not know how she could pay the doctor's bills and hospital expenses. De Vincenzo was touched by her story, and he took out a pen and endorsed his winning check for payment to the	Clubhouse /ˈklʌb.haʊs/ **(n)** trụ sở câu lạc bộ Endorse /ɪnˈdɔːrs/ **(v)** chứng thực đằng sau (séc), ký phía sau Official /əˈfɪʃ.əl/ **(n)** viên chức, công chức Phony /ˈfəʊ.ni/ **(n)** kẻ giả dối, kẻ đạo đức giả

woman. "Make some good days for the baby," he said as he pressed the check into her hand. The next week, he was having lunch in a country club when a Professional Golf Association official came to his table. "Some of the boys in the parking lot last week told me you met a young woman there after you won that tournament." De Vincenzo nodded. "Well," said the official, "I have news for you. She's a phony. She has no sick baby. She's not even married. She fleeced you, my friend." "You mean there is no baby who is dying?" said De Vincenzo. "That's right," said the official. "That's the best news I've heard all week," De Vincenzo said. **- The Best of Bits & Pieces**	Fleece /fliːs/ **(v)** lừa đảo
Two men look out through the same bars: One sees the mud, and one the stars. **- Frederick Langbridge**	Bar /bɑːr/ **(adv)** chấn song (trong tù)



40. AN AGELESS HEART

The cruise ship was crowded with people off for three days of pleasure. Ahead of me in the passageway walked a tiny woman in brown slacks, her shoulders hunched, her white hair cut in a bob. From the ship's intercom came a familiar tune - "Begin the Beguine." And suddenly, a wonderful thing happened. The woman, unaware anyone was behind her, did a quick and graceful dance step - back, shuffle, slide.	Ageless /ˈeɪdʒ.ləs/ **(adj)** trẻ mãi không già Cruise ship /ˈkruːz ˌʃɪp/ **(n)** tàu du lịch Hunch /hʌntʃ/ **(v)** khoằm, gập cong Intercom /ˈɪn.ʈər.kɑːm/ **(n)** hệ thống liên lạc

As she reached the door to the dining salon, she re-assembled her dignity, and stepped soberly through. Younger people often think folks my age are beyond romance, dancing or dreams. They see us as age has shaped us; camouflaged by wrinkles, thick waists and gray hair. They don't see the people who live inside. No one would ever know that I am still the skinny girl who grew up in a leafy suburb of Boston. Inside, I still think of myself as the youngest child in a happy family headed by a mother of great beauty and a father of unfailing good cheer. And I am still the romantic teenager who longed for love, the young adult who aspired to social respectability - but whom shall I tell? We are all like the woman in the ship's passageway, in whom the music still echoes. We are the sum of all the lives we once lived. We show the grown-up part, but inside we are still the laughing children, the shy teens, the dream-filled youths. There still exists, most real, the matrix of all we were or ever yearned to be. In our hearts we still hear "Begin the Beguine" - and when we are alone, we dance. **- Beth Ashley**	Re-assemble /ˌriː.əˈsem.bəl/ **(v)** điều chỉnh lại, sắp xếp lại Soberly /ˈsoʊ.bər.li/ **(n)** (một cách) chín chắn, nghiêm trang Camouflage /ˈkæm.ə.flɑːʒ/ **(v)** ngụy trang Skinny /əˈfɪʃ.əl/ **(adj)** gầy nhom, gầy trơ xương Unfailing /ʌnˈfeɪ.lɪŋ/ **(adj)** liên tục, bền bỉ, không ngừng Respectability /rɪˌspek.təˈbɪl.ə.ţi/ **(n)** (sự) đáng được tôn trọng Matrix /ˈmeɪ.trɪks/ **(n)** ma trận Yearn /jɜːrn/ **(v)** mong mỏi, ao ước, khao khát
How far you go in life depends on your being tender with the young, compassionate with the aged, sympathetic with the striving, and tolerant of the weak and the strong. Because someday in life, you will have been all of these. **- George Washington Carver**	Tender /ˈten.dər/ **(adj)** nhân hậu, dịu dàng Tolerant /ˈtɑː.lər.ənt/ **(adj)** dung thứ, khoan dung



41. THE COOKIE THIEF

A woman was waiting at an airport one night. With several long hours before her flight, She hunted for a book in the airport shop, Bought a bag of cookies and found a place to drop. She was engrossed in her book, but happened to see That the man beside her, as bold as could be, Grabbed a cookie or two from the bag between, Which she tried to ignore to avoid a scene. She read, munched cookies and watched the clock, As the gutsy "cookie thief" diminished her stock. She was getting more irritated as the minutes ticked by, Thinking, "If I wasn't so nice, I'd blacken his eye!" With each cookie she took, he took one, too. When only one was left, she wondered what he'd do. With a smile on his face and a nervous laugh, He took the last cookie and broke it in half. He offered her half, as he ate the other. She snatched it from him and thought, "Oh brother, This guy has some nerve, and he's also rude. Why, he didn't even show any gratitude!" She had never known when she had been so galled, And sighed with relief when her flight was called. She gathered her belongings and headed for the gate, Refusing to look back at the "thieving ingrate." She boarded the plane and sank in her seat, Then sought her book, which was almost complete. As she reached in her baggage, she gasped with surprise. There was her bag of cookies in front of her eyes! "If mine are here," she moaned with despair, "Then the other were his and he tried to share!" Too late to apologize, she realized with grief That she was the rude one, the ingrate, the thief! **- Valerie Cox**	Engrossed /ɪnˈgroʊst/ **(adj)** mải mê, bị cuốn hút Bold /boʊld/ **(adj)** cả gan, trơ trẽn, can đảm Munch /mʌntʃ/ **(v)** nhai, nhai tóp tép Gutsy /ˈgʌt.si/ **(adj)** gan góc, dũng cảm Diminish /dɪˈmɪn.ɪʃ/ **(v)** làm giảm bớt, thu nhỏ Stock /stɑːk/ **(n)** cái đang có; kho dự trữ, nguồn cung cấp Irritated /ˈɪr.ə.teɪ.ʈɪd/ **(adj)** tức tối, cáu tiết Tick /tɪk/ **(v)** trôi qua (thời gian) Snatch /snætʃ/ **(v)** túm, chộp, giật lấy Gall /gɑːl/ **(v)** chọc tức, làm phiền, làm khó chịu Ingrate /ˈɪŋ.greɪt/ **(n)** kẻ bội ơn, kẻ vô ơn bạc nghĩa Gasp /gæsp/ **(v)** há hốc miệng vì kinh ngạc; thở hổn hển Moan /moʊn/ **(v)** kêu van, rền rĩ
Do unto others as you would have them do unto you. **- Matt. 7:12**	Unto = to /ˈʌn.tu/ **(prep)** đến, tới



42. WHERE I'M BELONGING

A little girl whose parents had died lived with her grandmother and slept in an upstairs bedroom.

One night, there was a fire in the house and the grandmother perished while trying to rescue the child. The fire spread quickly, and the first floor of the house was soon engulfed in flames.

Neighbors called the fire department, then stood helplessly by, unable to enter the house because flames blocked all the entrances. The little girl appeared at an upstairs window, crying for help, just as word spread among the crowd that firefighters would be delayed a few minutes because they were all at another fire.

Suddenly, a man appeared with a ladder, put it up against the side of the house and disappeared inside. When he reappeared, he had the little girl in his arms. He delivered the child to the waiting arms below, then disappeared into the night.

An investigation revealed that the child had no living relatives, and weeks later a meeting was held to determine who would take the child into their home and bring her up.

A teacher said she would like to raise the child. She pointed out that she could ensure her a good education. A farmer offered her an upbringing on his farm. He pointed out that living on a farm was healthy and satisfying. Others spoke, giving their reasons why it was to the child's advantage to live with them. Finally, the town's richest resident arose and said: "I can give this child all the advantages that you have mentioned here, plus money and everything that money can buy."

Perish /ˈper.ɪʃ/ **(v)** chết, bỏ mạng

Engulf /ɪnˈgʌlf/ **(v)** nhấn chìm, chôn vùi

Upbringing /ˈʌpˌbrɪŋ.ɪŋ/ **(n)** sự nuôi dạy, sự dạy dỗ (trẻ con)

Gait /geɪt/ **(n)** dáng đi

Leap /liːp/ **(n)** sự nhảy, cú nhảy

Fateful /ˈfeɪt.fəl/ **(adj)** do số mệnh; đau buồn, tang thương

Sob /sɑːb/ **(v)** nức nở

Adjourn /əˈdʒɜːrn/ **(v)** dời lại, hoãn lại, ngừng

Throughout all this, the child remained silent, her eyes on the floor. "Does anyone else want to speak?" asked the meeting chairman. A man came forward from the back of the hall. His gait was slow and he seemed in pain. When he got to the front of the room, he stood directly before the little girl and held out his arms. The crowd gasped. His hand and arms were terribly scarred. The child cried out: "This is the man who rescued me!" With a leap, she threw her arms around the man's neck, holding on for dear life, just as she had that fateful night. She buried her face on his shoulder and sobbed for a few moments. Then she looked up and smiled at him. "This meeting is adjourned," said the chairman. **- Unknown**	
Not he who has much is rich, but he who gives much. **- Erich Fromm**	



43. ROLES - AND HOW WE PLAY THEM

Whenever I'm disappointed with my spot in life, I stop and think about little Jamie Scott. Jamie was trying out for a part in a school play. His mother told me that he'd set his heart on being in it, though she feared he would not be chosen. On the day the parts were awarded, I went with her to collect him after school. Jamie rushed up to her, eyes shining with pride and excitement. "Guess what, Mum," he shouted, and then said	Set his heart on being in it - đặt cả trái tim của cậu bé vào việc đó

those words that remain a lesson to me: "I've been chosen to clap and cheer." **- Marie Curling**	
If you look at what you have in life, you'll always have more. If you look at what you don't have in life, you'll never have enough. **- Oprah Winfrey**	



44. THE BALD BOYS

I once read this on a local paper. On an inside page, there was an article that I believe ought to have been the front-page headline news. The article wrote about a 15-year-old boy with a brain tumor. He was undergoing radiation and chemotherapy treatments. As a result of those treatments, he had lost all of his hair. I remember how I would have felt about that at his age - I would have been mortified! This young man's classmates spontaneously came to the rescue: all the boys in his grade asked their family if they could shave their heads so that Brian wouldn't be the only bald boy in the high school. There, on that page, was a photograph of a mother shaving off all of her son's hair, with the family looking on approvingly. **- Hanoch McCarty**	Front-page /ˌfrʌntˈpeɪdʒ/ **(adj)** trên trang đầu Undergo /ˌʌn.dərˈgoʊ/ **(v)** chịu đựng, trải qua (khó khăn, đau đớn) Radiation /ˌreɪ.diˈeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** liệu pháp bức xạ (xạ trị) Mortify /ˈmɔːr.ɾə.faɪ/ **(v)** mất thể diện, làm cho xấu hổ Spontaneously /spɑːnˈteɪ.ni.əs.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) tự ý, tự nhiên, tự phát Approvingly /əˈpruː.vɪŋ.li/ **(adv)** ra vẻ hài lòng, tán thành



45. THE MIRACLE BRIDGE

The Brooklyn Bridge that spans the river between Manhattan and Brooklyn is simply an engineering miracle. In 1883, a creative engineer, John Roebling, was inspired by an idea for this spectacular bridge project. However, bridge-building experts told him to forget it, it just was not possible. Roebling convinced his son, Washington, an up-and-coming engineer, that the bridge could be built. The two of them conceived the concept of how it could be accomplished, and how to overcome the obstacles. Somehow they convinced bankers to finance the project. Now with unharnessed excitement and energy, they hired their crew and began to build their dream bridge. The project was only a few months under way when a tragic on-site accident killed John Roebling and severely injured his son. Washington was severely brain-damaged, unable to talk or walk. Everyone thought that the project would have been scrapped since the Roeblings were the only ones who understood how the bridge could be built. Though Washington Roebling was unable to move or talk, his mind was as sharp as ever. One day, as he lay in his hospital bed, an idea flashed in his mind as to how to develop a communication code. All he could move was one finger, so he touched the arm of his wife with that finger. He tapped out the code to communicate to her what she was to tell the engineers who continued building the bridge. For 13 years, Washington tapped out his instructions with one finger until the spectacular Brooklyn Bridge was finally completed. **- From Brian Cavanaugh's A Fresh Packet of Sower's seeds**	Span /spæn/ **(v)** bắc qua, kéo dài qua Up-and-coming /ˌʌp.ənˈkʌm.ɪŋ/ **(adj)** hứa hẹn, đầy triển vọng Conceive /kənˈsiːv/ **(v)** hình thành trong đầu, nghĩ ra Unharnessed /ʌnˈhɑːr.nəsd/ **(adj)** không bị kềm giữ Tragic /ˈtrædʒ.ɪk/ **(adj)** bi thảm, bi kịch, thảm thương On-site /ˌɑːnˈsaɪt/ **(adj)** tại công trường, tại chỗ Scrap /skræp/ **(v)** bỏ đi, loại bỏ



46. A LESSON IN HEART

A lesson in "heart" is my little, 10-year-old daughter, Sarah, who was born with a muscle missing in her foot and wears a brace all the time. She came home one beautiful spring day to tell me she had competed in "field day" - that's where they have lots of races and other competitive events. Because of her leg support, my mind raced as I tried to think of encouragement for my Sarah, things I could say to her about not letting this get her down - but before I could get a word out, she said, "Daddy, I won two of the races!" I couldn't believe it! And then Sarah said, "I had an advantage." Ahh! I knew it. I thought she must have been given a head start... some kind of physical advantage. but again, before I could say anything, she said, "Daddy, I didn't get a head start... my advantage was I had to try harder!" **- Stan Frager**	Brace /breɪs/ **(n)** nẹp, trụ chống Race /reɪs/ **(v)** chạy đua, quay cuồng (tâm trí)



47. OBSTACLES

We who lived in the concentration camps can remember the men who walked through the huts comforting others, giving away their last piece of bread. They may have been	Hut /hʌt/ **(n)** túp lều

few in number, but they offer sufficient proof that everything can be taken from a man but one thing: The last of his freedoms - to choose one's attitude in any given set of circumstances, to choose one's own way. **- Viktor E. Frankl**	Circumstance /ˈsɜːr.kəm.stæns/ **(n)** hoàn cảnh, tình huống
The greatest power that a person possesses is the power to choose. **J. Martin Kohe**	Possess /pəˈzes/ **(v)** sở hữu



48. LESSONS FROM A JIGSAW PUZZLE

Don't force a fit. If something is meant to be, it will come together naturally. When things aren't going so well, take a break. Everything will look different when you return. Be sure to look at the big picture. Getting hung up on the little pieces only leads to frustration. Perseverance pays off. Every important puzzle went together bit by bit, piece by piece. When one spot stops working, move to another. But be sure to come back later. Establish the border first. Boundaries give a sense of security and order. Don't be afraid to try different combinations. Some matches are surprising. Anything worth doing takes time and effort. A great puzzle can't be rushed. Take time to celebrate your successes, even little ones. They will encourage you to go ahead. **- Author Unknown**	Going so well - suôn sẻ Hung up /ˌhʌŋ ˈʌp/ **(adj)** bị ám ảnh, lo lắng Frustration /frʌsˈtreɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** tâm trạng thất vọng / sụp đổ Perseverance /ˌpɜːr.səˈvɪr.əns/ **(n)** tính kiên trì, sự bền chí Border /ˈbɔːr.dər/ **(n)** biên giới, đường viền Boundary /baʊn.dər.i/ **(n)** đường biên giới, ranh giới

Life is not the sum of what we have been, but what we yearn to be. **- Jose Ortegay Gasset**	



49. WHAT'S REALLY IMPORTANT?

A few years ago at the Seattle Special Olympics, nine contestants, all physically or mentally disabled, assembled at the starting line for the 100-yard dash. At the gun they all started out, not exactly in a dash, but with the relish to run the race to the finish and win. All, that is, except one boy who stumbled on the asphalt, tumbled over a couple of times, and began to cry. The other eight heard the boy cry. They slowed down and paused. Then they all turned around and went back. Every one of them. One girl with Down's syndrome bent down and kissed him and said, "This will make it better." Then all nine linked arms and walked together to the finish line. Everyone in the stadium stood and the cheering went on for ten minutes. **- Bob French**	Dash /dæʃ/ **(n)** cuộc đua ngắn, chạy cự li ngắn Relish /ˈrel.ɪʃ/ **(n)** sự hứng thú, sự say mê Stumble /ˈstʌm.bəl/ **(v)** vấp, trượt chân Asphalt /ˈæs.fɑːlt/ **(n)** nhựa đường Tumble /ˈtʌm.bəl/ **(v)** ngã, đổ nhào A couple of times - một vài lần



50. CONSIDER THIS

In 1889, Rudyard Kipling - an author won the Literature Nobel Prize in 1907 - received the following rejection letter from the San Francisco Examiner. "I'm sorry, Mr. Kipling, but you just don't know how to use the English language."

Winston Churchill failed sixth grade. He did not become Prime Minister of England until he was 62, and then only after a lifetime of defeats and setbacks. His greatest contributions came when he was a "senior citizen."

Albert Einstein did not speak until he was four years old and didn't read until he was seven. His teacher described him as "mentally slow, unsociable and adrift forever in his foolish dreams." He was expelled and was refused admittance to the Zurich Polytechnic School.

Louis Pasteur was only a mediocre pupil in undergraduate studies and ranked 15th out of 22 in chemistry.

General Douglas MacArthur was turned down for admission to West Point not once but twice. But he tried a third time, was accepted and marched into the history books.

In 1944, Emmeline Snively, director of the Blue Book Modeling Agency, told modeling hopeful Norma Jean Baker (Marilyn Monroe), "You'd better learn secretarial work or else get married."

While turning down the British rock group called The Beatles, one executive of Decca Recording Company said, "We don't like their sound. Groups of guitars are on the way out."

In 1954, Jimmy Denny, manager of the Grand Ole Opry, fired Elvis Presley after one performance. He told Presley, "You ain't goin' nowhere... son. You ought to go back to drivin' a truck."

When Alexander Graham Bell invented the telephone in 1876, it did not ring off the hook with calls from potential backers. President Rutherford Hayes said, "That's an amazing invention, but who would ever want to use one of them?"

When Thomas Edison invented the light bulb, he tried over 2,000 experiments before he got it to work. A young reporter asked him how it felt to fail so many times. He said, "I

Prime Minister /ˌpraɪm ˈmɪn.ɪ.stər/ **(n)** thủ tướng chính phủ

Defeat /dɪˈfiːt/ **(n)** sự thất bại

Setback /ˈset.bæk/ **(n)** sự thụt lùi, chướng ngại, vấn đề

Senior citizen /ˌsiː.njər ˈsɪt̬.ɪ.zən/ **(n)** công dân cao tuổi, người già

Adrift /əˈdrɪft/ **(adj)** phiêu bạt, lênh đênh

Expel /ɪkˈspel/ **(v)** đuổi, trục xuất, tống ra

Admittance /ədˈmɪt̬.əns/ **(n)** (sự) nhận vào, cho phép vào (một nơi chốn, địa điểm...)
*ở đây đề cập đến hành động nhập học

Mediocre /ˌmiː.diˈoʊ.kər/ **(adj)** xoàng, tầm thường

Undergraduate /ˌʌn.dərˈgrædʒ.u.ət/ **(n)** sinh viên chưa tốt nghiệp

Turn down **(ph.v)** từ chối, gạt bỏ

Admission /ədˈmɪʃ.ən/ **(n)** (sự) nhận vào, cho phép vào (một tổ chức xã hội, cơ quan, trường học…)
*bạn có thể được nhận vào (admission) một trường đại học vài tháng trước khi năm học bắt đầu, sau đó sẽ đến việc nhập học (admittance) xảy ra)

never failed once. I invented the light bulb. It just happened to be a 2,000- step process." After years of progressive hearing loss, by age 46 German composer Ludwig van Beethoven had become completely deaf. Nevertheless, he wrote his greatest music - including five symphonies - during his later years. **- Jack Canfield and Mark Victor Hansen**	On the way out - trở nên lỗi thời, đi xuống, không còn được ưu ái Ring off the hook - reo liên tục, đỗ chuông suốt (reo đến mức rớt khỏi giá đỡ) Backer /ˈbæk.ər/ **(n)** người tài trợ, người ủng hộ Progressive /prəˈgres.ɪv/ **(adj)** tăng dần lên, tăng lên không ngừng
Failure is only the opportunity to begin again more intelligently. **- Henry Ford**	



51. THE BEAUTY REMAINS; THE PAIN PASSES

Although Henri Matisse was nearly twenty-eight years younger than Auguste Renoir, the two great artists were dear friends and frequent companions. When Renoir was confined to his home during the last decade of his life, Matisse visited him daily. Renoir, almost paralyzed by arthritis, continued to paint in spite of his infirmities. One day, as Matisse watched the elder painter working in his studio, fighting torturous pain with each brush stroke, he blurted out: "Auguste, why do you continue to paint when you	Confine /dɪˈfiːt/ **(v)** giam giữ, giam cầm Paralyze /ˈper.əl.aɪz/ **(v)** làm tê liệt Arthritis /ɑːrˈθraɪ.ţəs/ **(n)** chứng viêm khớp Infirmity /ɪnˈfɜːr.mə.ţi/ **(n)** tính chất yếu ớt, tính chất ốm yếu

are in such agony?" Renoir answered simply: "The beauty remains; the pain passes." And so, almost to his dying day, Renoir put paint to canvas. One of his most famous paintings, the Bathers, was completed just two years before his passing, fourteen years after he was stricken by this disabling disease. **- The Best of Bits & Pieces**	Torturous /ˈtɔːr.tʃər.əs/ **(adj)** giày vò, gây đau khổ, hành hạ, tra tấn Stroke /stroʊk/ **(n)** nét (bút) Blurt (out) /blɜrt/ **(v)** thốt ra Agony /ˈæg.ə.ni/ **(n)** sự đau đớn cực độ (về thể xác và tinh thần) Strike /straɪk/ **(v)** tấn công (v3: stricken /ˈstrɪk.ən/)
Weakness of character is the only defeat which cannot be amended. **- Francois de la Rochefoucald**	Amend /əˈmend/ **(v)** sửa đổi, cải thiện



52. WE NEVER TOLD HIM HE COULDN'T DO IT

My son Joey was born with club feet. The doctors assured us that with treatment he would be able to walk normally - but would never run very well. The first three years of his life were spent in surgery, casts and braces. By the time he was eight, you wouldn't know he had a problem when you saw him walk. The children in our neighborhood ran around as most children do during play, and Joey would jump right in and run	Club foot **(n)** dị tật bẩm sinh ở chân, vẹo chân (số nhiều: feet) Assure /əˈʃʊr/ **(v)** đảm bảo, quả quyết, cam đoan Cast /kæst/ **(n)** (khuôn) bó bột

and play, too. We never told him that he probably wouldn't be able to run as well as the other children. So he didn't know. In seventh grade he decided to go out for the cross-country team. Every day he trained with the team. He worked harder and ran more than any of the others - perhaps he sensed that the abilities that seemed to come naturally to so many others did not come naturally to him. Although the entire team runs, only the top seven runners have the potential to score points for the school. We didn't tell him he probably would never make the team, so he didn't know. He continued to run four to five miles a day, every day - even the day he had a 103- degree fever. I was worried, so I went to look for him after school. I found him running all alone. I asked him how he felt. "Okay," he said. He had two more miles to go. The sweat ran down his face and his eyes were glassy from his fever. Yet he looked straight ahead and kept running. We never told him he couldn't run four miles with a 103- degree fever. So he didn't know. Two weeks later, the names of the team runners were called. Joey was number six on the list. Joey had made the team. He was in seventh grade - the other six team members were all eighth-graders. We never told him he shouldn't expect to make the team. We never told him he couldn't do it. We never told him he couldn't do it... so he didn't know. He just did it. **- Kathy Lamancusa**	Cross-country /ˌkrɑːsˈkʌn.tri/ **(adj)** chạy việt dã Glassy /ˈglæs.i/ **(adj)** đờ đẫn, không hồn
All shining pearls, all great men, all true values require time as an evidence. **- Unknown**	



53. THE PASSIONATE PURSUIT OF POSSIBILITY

Years ago, while unearthing an ancient Egyptian tomb, an archaeologist came upon seeds buried in a piece of wood. Planted, the seeds realized their potential after more than 3,000 years! Are there conditions in the lives of people so discouraging, so defeating, that human beings - regardless of inherent potentiality - are doomed to lives of failure and quiet desperation? Or are there also seeds of possibility in people, an urge for becoming that is so strong, that the hard crust of adversity is breached? Consider this story that came over the wires of the Associated Press on May 23, 1984:

As a child, Mary Groda did not learn to read and write. Experts labeled her retarded. As an adolescent she "earned" an additional label, "incorrigible," and was sentenced to two years in a reformatory. It was here, ironically, in this closed-in place, that Mary - bending to the challenge to learn - worked at her task for as long as 16 hours a day. Her hard work paid off. She was awarded her (GED) high school diploma.

But more misfortune was to visit Mary Groda. After leaving the reformatory, she became pregnant without benefit of marriage. Then, two years later a second pregnancy resulted in a stroke, erasing her hard-earned powers of reading and writing. With the help and support of her father, Mary battled back, regaining what she had lost.

In dire financial straits, Mary went on welfare. Finally, to make ends meet, she took in seven foster children. It was during this period that she started taking courses at a community college. Upon completion of her course work, she applied to and was accepted by the Albany Medical School to study medicine.

In the spring of 1984 in Oregon, Mary Groda Lewis - she's married now - paraded in full academic regalia across the graduation stage. No one can know what private thoughts went through Mary's mind as she reached out to grasp this eloquent testimony to her self-belief and perseverance, her diploma that announced to all the world: Here stands on this very small point of planet Earth a person who dared to dream the impossible dream, a person

Unearth /ʌnˈɜːrθ/ **(v)** khai quật

Egyptian tomb /ɪˈdʒɪpʃən/ /tuːm/ lăng mộ Ai Cập

Archaeologist /ˌɑːr.kiˈɑː.lə.dʒɪst/ **(n)** nhà khảo cổ

Inherent /ɪnˈherənt/ **(n)** vốn có

Doom /duːm/ **(v)** đọa đày, bắt phải chịu

Crust /krʌst/ **(n)** vỏ

Adversity /ədˈvɜːr.sə.t̬i/ **(n)** nghịch cảnh

Breach /briːtʃ/ **(v)** chọc thủng

Retarded /rɪˈtɑːr.dɪd/ **(adj)** chậm phát triển (trí tuệ)

Adolescent /ˌæd.əˈles.ənt/ **(n)** thanh thiếu niên (13 - 17 tuổi)

Incorrigible /ɪnˈkɔːr.ə.dʒə.bəl/ **(adj)** bất trị

Sentence /ˈsen.təns/ **(v)** kết án

Reformatory /rɪˈfɔːr.mə.tɔːr.i/ **(n)** trại cải tạo

Ironically /aɪˈrɑː.nɪ.kəl.i/ **(adv)** mỉa mai, trớ trêu

Dire strait /daɪr/ - /streɪt/ tình cảnh khó khăn, tuyệt vọng

Make ends meet - kiếm đủ tiền để sống

Seven foster /ˈfɑː.stər/ **(adj)** children - 7 đứa trẻ bảo trợ

Parade /pəˈreɪd/ **(v)** diễu hành

who confirms for all of us our human divineness. Here stands Mary Groda Lewis, MD. **- James E. Conner**	Regalia /rɪˈgeɪ.li.ə/ **(n)** lễ phục Eloquent /ˈel.ə.kwənt/ **(adj)** hùng hồn Testimony /ˈtes.tə.moʊ.ni/ **(n)** bằng chứng, sự chứng nhận Divineness /dɪˈvaɪn.nəs/ **(n)** sự siêu phàm
Cherish your visions and your dreams as they are the children of your soul; the blueprints of your ultimate achievements. **- Napoleon Hill**	Blueprint /ˈbluː.prɪnt/ **(n)** bản thiết kế, hình mẫu



54. ARE YOU STRONG ENOUGH TO HANDLE CRITICS?

It is not the critic who counts, not the man who points out how the strong man stumbles or where the doer of deeds could have done them better. The credit belongs to the man who is actually in the arena, whose face is marred by dust and sweat and blood, who strives valiantly, who errs and comes short again and again because there is no effort without error and shortcomings, who knows the great devotion, who spends himself in a worthy cause, who at his best knows in the end the hight achievement of triumph and who at worst, if he fails while daring greatly, knows his place shall never be with those timid and cold souls who know neither victory nor defeat. **- Theodore Roosevelt**	Critic /ˈkrɪt̬.ɪk/ **(n)** nhà phê bình, người chỉ trích Deed /diːd/ **(n)** việc làm, hành động Credit /ˈkred.ɪt/ **(n)** sự công nhận, vinh dự Arena /əˈriː.nə/ **(n)** đấu trường, vũ đài Mar /mɑːr/ **(v)** làm hư, làm sây sát, làm xước Valiantly /ˈvæl.i.ənt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) dũng cảm

	Err /ɛr/ **(v)** phạm sai lầm Shortcoming /ˈʃɔːrtˌkʌm.ɪŋ/ **(n)** lỗi, điều thiếu sót Timid /ˈtɪm.ɪd/ **(adj)** nhút nhát, dễ sợ hãi
Your chances of success in any undertaking can always be measured by your belief in yourself. **- Robert Collier**	Undertaking /ˈʌn.dərˌteɪ.kɪŋ/ **(n)** công việc, nhiệm vụ



55. THE PRETTIEST ANGEL

For the past 20 years, I have spoken to all kinds of audiences in the character of Benjamin Franklin, complete with costume. One day, I was visiting and talking with pupils of a primary school. One student raised his hand and said, "I thought you died." This was not an unusual question and I tried to find a suitable answer by saying, "Well, I did die on April 17, 1790, when I was 84 years old, but I didn't like it and I'm never going to do it again." I immediately asked for any other questions and called on a boy at the back of the room who raised his hand. He asked, "When you were in Heaven, did you see my mother there?" My heart stopped. I wanted the floor to open up and swallow me. My only thought was, don't blow this! I realized for an 11-year-old boy to ask that question in front of all of his classmates, it had to either be a very recent occurrence or of	Costume /ˈkɑː.stuːm/ **(n)** trang phục (để hóa trang) Occurrence /əˈkɜːr.əns/ **(n)** sự kiện, sự cố, chuyện xảy ra Utmost /ˈʌt.moʊst/ **(adj)** vô cùng, cực kỳ

utmost concern. I also knew I had to say something to comfort him. Then I heard my voice say: "I'm not sure among I met was your mother, but if it is true, she was the prettiest angel there." The smile on his face told me that it was the right answer. I'm not sure where it came from, but I think I just may have had a little help from the prettiest angel there. **- Ralph Archbold**	
The heart of a fool is in his mouth, but the mouth of a wise man is in his heart. **- Benjamin Franklin**	



56. BUT YOU DIDN'T

I looked at you and smiled the other day. I thought you'd see me but you didn't. I said "I love you" and waited for what you would say. I thought you'd hear me but you didn't. I asked you to come outside and play ball with me. I thought you'd follow me but you didn't. I drew a picture just for you to see. I thought you'd save it but you didn't. I made a fort for us back in the woods. I thought you'd camp with me but you didn't. I found some worms and such for fishing if we could. I thought you'd want to go but you didn't.	Fort /fɔːrt/ **(n)** pháo đài Worm /wɜːrm/ **(n)** con giun

I needed you just to talk to, my thoughts to share. I thought you'd want to but you didn't. I told you about the game hoping you'd be there. I thought you'd surely come but you didn't. I asked you to share my youth with me. I thought you'd want to but you couldn't. My country called me to war, you asked me to come home safely. But I didn't. - **Stan Gebhardt**	
Death is a challenge. It tells us not to waste time. It tell us to tell each other right now that we love each other. - **Leo Buscaglia**	



57. TO REMEMBER ME

The day will come when my body will lie upon a white sheet neatly tucked under four corners of a mattress located in a hospital busily occupied with the living and the dying. At a certain moment a doctor will determine that my brain has ceased to function and that, for all intents and purposes, my life has stopped. When that happens, do not attempt to instill artificial life into my body by the use of a machine. And don't call this my deathbed. Let it be called the Bed of Life, and let my body be taken from it to help others lead fuller lives. Give my eyes to the man who has never seen a sunrise, a baby's face or love in the eyes of a woman. Give my heart to a person whose own heart has caused nothing but endless days of pain. Give my blood to the teenager who was pulled	Tuck /tʌk/ **(v)** đút, nhét vào Mattress /ˈmæt.rəs/ **(n)** nệm, đệm Occupy /ˈɑː.kjə.paɪ/ **(v)** tốn hết thời giờ, làm cho bận rộn Cease /siːs/ **(v)** ngừng, không còn Function /ˈfʌŋk.ʃən/ **(v)** hoạt động, thực hiện chức năng Intent /ɪnˈtent/ **(n)** ý định, mục đích

from the wreckage of his car, so that he might live to see his grandchildren play. Give my kidneys to one who depends on a machine to exist from day to day. Take my bones, every muscle, every fiber and nerve in my body and find a way to make a crippled child walk. Explore every corner of my brain. Take my cells, if necessary, and let them grow so that, someday, a speechless boy will shout at the crack of a bat and a deaf girl will hear the sound of rain against her window. Burn what is left of me and scatter the ashes to the winds to help the flowers grow and blossom. If you must bury something, let it be my faults, my weaknesses and all prejudice against the others around me. Give my sins to the devil. Give my soul to God. If, by chance, you wish to remember me, do it with a kind deed or word to someone who needs you. If you do all I have asked, I will live forever. - **Robert N. Test**	Instill (= instil) /ɪnˈstɪl/ **(v)** truyền dẫn Wreckage /ˈrek.ɪdʒ/ **(n)** mảnh vụn, đống đổ nát Fiber (= fibre) /ˈfaɪ.bər/ **(n)** sợi, thớ (tạo thành mô) Crack /kræk/ **(n)** tiếng kêu chói tai Scatter /ˈskæţ.ər/ **(v)** rải, rắc Ashes /ˈæʃ·əz/ **(n)** tro hỏa táng (số nhiều của ash) Prejudice /ˈpredʒ.ə.dɪs/ **(n)** định kiến, thành kiến Sin /sɪn/ **(n)** tội, lỗi lầm



58. PLEASE DRESS ME IN RED

In my profession, I have worked with children who have the virus that causes AIDS. The relationships that I have had with these special kids have been valuable gifts in my life. Let me tell you a story about the courage of Tyler. Tyler was born infected with HIV from his mother. From the very beginning of his life, he was dependent on medications to enable him to survive. At times, he also needed supplemental oxygen to support his breathing.	Supplemental /ˌsʌp.lɪˈmen.təl/ **(adj)** bổ sung, phụ thêm vào Deadly /ˈded.li/ **(adj)** nguy hiểm, gây chết người, chết chóc Medicine-laden /ˈmed.ɪ.sən - ˈleɪ.dən/ **(adj)** chất đầy thuốc

Tyler wasn't willing to give up one single moment of his childhood to this deadly disease. It was not unusual to find him playing and racing around his backyard, wearing his medicine-laden backpack and dragging his tank of oxygen behind him in his little wagon. Tyler's pure joy in being alive gave him energy that caused all of us who knew him to marvel. Tyler's mom often recognized that he moved so fast, she dressed him in red. That way, when she peered out the window to check on him playing in the yard, she could quickly spot him. This dreaded disease eventually wore down even the likes of a little dynamo like Tyler. He became quite ill and, unfortunately, so did his mother. When it became apparent that he wasn't going to survive, Tyler's mom talked to him and she comforted him by telling Tyler that she was dying, too, and that she would be with him soon in heaven. A few days before his death, Tyler beckoned me over to his hospital bed and whispered, "I might die soon. I'm not scared. When I die, please dress me in red. Mom promised she's coming to heaven, too. I'll be playing when she gets there, and I want to make sure she can find me." **- Cindy Dee Holms**	Wagon /ˈwæg.ən/ **(n)** xe kéo Peer (out) /ˈpɔːrt ˌkʌm.ɪŋ/ **(v)** nhìn, ngó (ra ngoài) Dreaded /ˈdred.ɪd/ **(adj)** kinh hoàng, khủng khiếp Wear down **(ph.v)** làm yếu dần (v2: wore) Like /laɪk/ **(n)** người (vật) thuộc loại như *even the likes of a little dynamo like Tyler - ngay cả những con người giàu nghị lực nhỏ bé như Tyler Dynamo /ˈdaɪ.nə.moʊ/ **(n)** người giàu nghị lực Beckon /ˈbek.ən/ **(v)** vẫy tay ra hiệu



59. THE ETERNAL OPTIMIST

We have been lucky to be blessed with three sons. Our middle son, Billy, is fondly known as "the eternal optimist." For example, he had always been an early riser and liked to get in our bed at 5 a.m. Although we would admonish him to be quiet and go back to sleep, he would say in a falsetto whisper, “It’s going to be a beautiful morning. I hear the birds singing." When we would ask him to stop talking, he would reply, "I not talking to you; I talking to me!"	Fondly /ˈfɑːnd.li/ **(adv)** trìu mến, âu yếm Admonish /ədˈmɑː.nɪʃ/ **(n)** khuyên nhủ, la rầy Falsetto /fɑːlˈseţ.oʊ/ **(n)** giọng the thé; giọng nam cao

In kindergarten, the teacher asked the class to draw a tiger. Art is not his strong suit, and his tiger came out with one eye that appeared to be shut. When asked why the tiger had one eye closed, he replied, "Because he's saying, 'Here's looking at you, kid!'" Once he got into an argument with his older brother about whether a man on TV was bald. Billy said, "He's not bald. He's only bald when he looks at you. When he walks away, he has lots of hair!" Our youngest son was stricken with a serious uremic syndrome on a Tuesday and died on the following Friday. The night after Tanner's funeral, I had laid down beside Billy to discuss the day, as we often did. On this night, we were lying in the dark with not much to say. Suddenly, Billy spoke, "I feel sorry for us, but I almost feel more sorry for all those other people." Which people was he talking about? "The people who never knew Tanner. Weren't we lucky to have had Tanner with us for 20 months. Just think, there are lots of people who were never lucky enough to know him at all. We are really lucky people." **- Beth Dalton**	Uremic /jʊˈriːmɪk/ **(adj)** thuộc chứng tăng urê huyết * Có bản ghi cụ thể là: Hemolytic Uremic Syndrome (HUS) - hội chứng tán huyết - tăng urê máu Funeral /ˈfjuː.nər.əl/ **(n)** đám tang, lễ tang



60. ALL I REMEMBER

One day, while I was sitting in a quiet room waiting for an appointment, a wave of longing swept over me. I checked to make sure I was awake and not dreaming, and I saw that I was as far removed from a dreamy state as one could possibly be. Each thought I had was like a drop of water disturbing a still pond, and I marveled at the peacefulness of each passing moment. Suddenly my mother's face appeared - my mother, as she had been before Alzheimer's disease had stripped her of	Longing /ˈlɑːŋ.ɪŋ/ niềm khát khao Strip /strɪp/ **(v)** tước, lấy đi Magnificent /mægˈnɪf.ə.sənt/ **(adj)** lộng lẫy, rất đẹp Crown /kraʊn/ **(v)** làm cho hoàn hảo, tôn lên

her mind, her humanity, and 50 pounds. Her magnificent silver hair crowned her sweet face. She was so real and so close I felt I could reach out and touch her. I even smelled the fragrance of Joy, her favorite perfume. S he seemed to be waiting and did not speak. I said, "Oh, Mother, I'm so sorry that you had to suffer with that horrible disease." She tipped her head slightly to one side, as though to acknowledge what I had said about her suffering. Then she smiled - a beautiful smile - and said very distinctly, "But all I remember is love." And she disappeared. I began to shiver in a room gone suddenly cold, and I knew in my bones that the love we give and receive is all that matters and is all that is remembered. Suffering disappears; love remains. Her words are the most valuable I have ever heard, and that moment is forever engraved on my heart. **- Bobbie Probste**	Fragrance /ˈfreɪ.grəns/ **(n)** mùi thơm phưng phức, hương thơm ngát Tip /tɪp/ **(v)** nghiêng As though /æz - ðoʊ/ như thể là, cứ như là (= As if) Distinctly /dɪˈstɪŋkt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) rõ ràng, rành mạch Shiver /ˈʃɪv.ər/ **(v)** run, rùng mình Engrave /ɪnˈgreɪv/ **(v)** in sâu, khắc sâu



61. NOT A ONE

Little Chad was a shy, quiet, young boy. One day, he came home and told his mother that he'd like to make a valentine for everyone in his class. Her heart sank. She thought, "I wish he wouldn't do that!" because she had watched the children when they walked home from school. They laughed and talked to each other. But Chad was never included. Nevertheless, she decided she would go along with her son. So she purchased the paper and glue and crayons. Night after night, Chad painstakingly made 35 valentines. Valentine's Day dawned, and Chad was beside himself with excitement. He carefully stacked them up, put them in a	Valentine /ˈvæl.ən.taɪn/ **(n)** thiệp chúc mừng (vào ngày 14/02) Painstakingly /ˈpeɪnzˌteɪ.kɪŋ.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) cẩn thận, chịu khó Stack /stæk/ **(v)** xếp đống, xếp chồng lên Bolt /boʊlt/ **(v)** cài chốt, đóng cửa bằng then

bag, and bolted out the door. His mother decided to bake him his favorite cookies and serve them nice and warm with a cool glass of milk when he came home from school. She just knew he would be disappointed, an d maybe that would ease the pain a little. It hurt her to think that he wouldn't get many valentines - maybe none at all. That afternoon she had the cookies and milk on the table. When she heard the children outside, she looked out the window. Sure enough there they came, laughing and having the best time. And, as always, there was Chad in the rear. He walked a little faster than usual. She fully expected him to burst into tears as soon as he got inside. His arms were empty, she noticed, and when the door opened she choked back the tears. "Mommy has some cookies and milk for you," she tried to be joyful. But he hardly heard her words. He just marched right on by, his face aglow, and all he could say was: "Not a one. Not a one." Her heart sank. And then he added, "I didn't forget a one, not a single one!" **- Dave Galloway**	Rear /rɪr/ **(n)** phía sau Burst into tears khóc òa lên, bật khóc Choke back the tears nuốt nước mắt, kìm nước mắt lại Aglow /əˈgloʊ/ **(adj)** ngời lên, rạng rỡ



62. ONE AT A TIME

I was walking down a beach at sunset. The beach was crowded but what I noticed was a boy, who kept picking something up and throwing it out into the water. As I approached even closer, I saw that the boy was picking up starfish that had been washed up on the beach and, one at a time, he was throwing them back into the water.	Wash up /wɑːʃ/ **(ph.v)** cuốn vào bờ, dạt vào bờ One at a time - lần lượt, từng lượt một Puzzled /ˈpʌz.əld/ **(adj)** không hiểu được, bối rối

I was puzzled. I approached the boy and said, "Good evening, my boy. I was wondering what you are doing." "I'm throwing these starfish back into the ocean. You see, it's low tide right now and all of these starfish have been washed up onto the shore. If I don't throw them back into the sea, they'll die up here from lack of oxygen." "I understand. But there must be thousands of starfish on this beach. You can't possibly get to all of them. And this is probably happening on hundreds of beaches all up and down this coast. And don't you realize that you can't possibly make a difference?" The boy smiled, bent down and picked up yet another starfish, and as he threw it back into the sea, he replied, "Made a difference to that one!" **- Jack Canfield and Mark Victor Hansen**	
To try is all. It matters not if one succeeds or fails outwardly. **- Robert Thibodeau**	Outwardly /ˈaʊt.wərd.li/ **(adv)** bề ngoài



63. SERVICE WITH A SMILE

A man wrote a letter to a small hotel in the Midwest town he planned to visit on his vacation. He wrote: I would very much like to bring my dog with me. He is well-groomed and very well-behaved. Would you be willing to permit me to keep him in my room with me at night? An immediate reply came from the hotel owner, who said.	Well-groomed /ˌwel ˈgruːmd/ **(adj)** chỉn chu, ăn mặc đẹp Bedclothes /ˈbed.kloʊðz/ **(n)** bộ đồ giường (gồm chăn, gối, nệm, khăn trải giường) Silverware /ˈsɪlvər.wer/ **(n)** dụng cụ ăn uống (dao, nĩa, muỗng); đồ làm bằng bạc

I've been operating this hotel for many years. In all that time, I've never had a dog steal towels, bedclothes or silverware or pictures off the walks. I've never had to evict a dog in the middle of the night for being drunk and disorderly. And I've never had a dog run out on a hotel bill. Yes, indeed, your dog is welcome at my hotel. And, if your dog will vouch for you, you're welcome to stay here, too. **- Karl Albrecht and Ron Zenke**	Evict /ɪˈvɪkt/ **(v)** đuổi Disorderly /dɪˈsɔːr.dər.li/ **(adj)** gây mất trật tự, lộn xộn run out on a hotel bill: Thiếu nợ tiền phòng Vouch (for) /vaʊtʃ/ **(v)** cam đoan, bảo đảm
If you could choose one characteristic that would get you through life, choose a sense of humour. **- Jennifer James**	



64. ENCOURAGEMENT

Some of the greatest success stories of history have followed a word of encouragement or an act of confidence by a loved one or a trusting friend. Had it not been for a confident wife, Sophia, we might not have listed among the great names of literature the name of Nathaniel Hawthorne. When Nathaniel, a heartbroken man, went home to tell his wife that he was a failure and had been fired from his job, she surprised him with an exclamation of joy. "Now," she said triumphantly, "you can write your book!" "Yes," replied the man, with sagging confidence, "and what shall we live on while I am writing it?"	Exclamation /ˌek.skləˈmeɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự kêu lớn, việc hét lên Triumphantly /traɪˈʌm.fənt.li/ **(adv)** (một cách) hân hoan, vui mừng Sagging /ˈsægɪŋ/ **(adj)** sụt xuống, chùng xuống Substantial /səbˈstæn.ʃəl/ **(adj)** đáng kể Exclaim /ɪkˈskleɪm/ **(v)** kêu lên

To his amazement, she opened a drawer and pulled out a substantial amount of money. "Where on earth did you get that?" he exclaimed. "I have always known that you were a man of genius," she told him. "I knew that someday you would write a masterpiece. So every week, out of the money you gave me for housekeeping, I saved a little bit. So here is enough to last us for one whole year." From her trust and confidence came one of the greatest novels of American literature, The Scarlet Letter. - **Nido Qubein**	Genius /ˈdʒiː.ni.əs/ **(n)** thiên tài Masterpiece /ˈmæs.tər.piːs/ **(n)** tác phẩm lớn, kiệt tác Housekeeping /ˈhaʊs.kiː.pɪŋ/ **(n)** công việc quản gia, việc dọn dẹp nhà cửa
It takes so little to make people happy. Just a touch, if we know how to give it, just a word fitly spoken... a slight readjustment of some bolt or pin or bearing in the delicate machinery of a soul. **- Frank Crane**	Bolt - pin - bearing: bu lông - chốt - ổ trục, ổ đỡ Delicate machinery /ˈdel.ə.kət/ /məˈʃiː.nər.i/ bộ máy tinh vi / tinh tế



65. DID THE EARTH MOVE FOR YOU?

Eleven-year-old Angela was stricken with a debilitating disease involving her nervous system. She was unable to walk, and the doctors did not hold out much hope of her ever recovering. The little girl was undaunted. There, lying in her hospital bed, she would vow to anyone who'd listen that she was definitely going to be walking again someday. She was transferred to a specialized rehabilitation hospital in the San Francisco Bay area. The therapists were charmed by her undefeatable spirit. They taught her about imaging about seeing herself walking. If it would do nothing else, it would at least give her hope and something positive to	Debilitating /dɪˈbɪl.ə.teɪ.ʈɪŋ/ **(adj)** làm yếu sức, làm suy nhược Nervous system /ˈnɜːr.vəs ˌsɪs.təm/ **(n)** hệ thần kinh Hold out **(ph.v)** đưa ra Undaunted /ʌnˈdɑːn.ʈɪd/ **(adj)** ngoan cường, không nản lòng

do in the long waking hours in her bed. Angela would work as hard as possible in physical therapy and in exercise sessions. But she worked just as hard lying there faithfully doing her imaging, visualizing herself moving, moving, moving! One day, as she was straining with all her might to imagine her legs moving again, it seemed as though a miracle happened: The bed moved! It began to move around the room! She screamed out, "Look what I'm doing! Look! Look! I can do it! I moved, I moved!" Of course, at this very moment everyone else in the hospital was screaming, too, and running for cover. People were screaming, equipment was falling, and glass was breaking. You see, it was an earthquake. But don't tell that to Angela. She's convinced that she did it. And now, only a few years later, she's back in school. On her own two legs. No crutches, no wheelchair. You see, anyone who can shake the earth between San Francisco and Oakland can conquer a piddling little disease, can't they? **- Hanoch McCarty**	Rehabilitation /ˌriː.həˌbɪl.əˈteɪ.ʃən/ **(n)** sự phục hồi Visualize /ˈvɪʒ.u.əl.aɪz/ **(v)** hình dung, mường tượng Strain /streɪn/ **(v)** ráng sức, gắng sức Run for cover - chạy để tìm chỗ ẩn nấp / chỗ trú Piddling /ˈpɪd.əl.ɪŋ/ **(adj)** tầm thường, nhỏ nhặt



66. THE STORY OF TWO SEEDS

Two seeds lay side by side in the fertile spring soil. The first seed said, "I want to grow! I want to send my roots deep into the soil beneath me, and thrust my sprouts through the earth's crust above me... I want to unfurl my tender buds like banners to announce the arrival of spring... I want to feel the warmth of the sun on my face and the blessing of the morning dew on my petals!" And so she grew. The second seed said, "I am afraid. If I send my roots into the ground below, I don't know what I will encounter in the	Fertile /ˈfɜːr.ţəl/ **(adj)** phì nhiêu, màu mỡ Thrust /θrʌst/ **(v)** đâm, đẩy Sprout /spraʊt/ **(n)** mầm, chồi Unfurl /ʌnˈfɜːrl/ **(v)** mở, bung (nảy lộc) Encounter /ɪnˈkaʊn.ţər/ **(v)** bắt gặp, đụng độ

dark. If I push my way through the hard soil above me I may damage my delicate sprouts... what if I let my buds open and a snail tries to eat them? And if I were to open my blossoms, small children may pull me from the ground. No, it is much better for me to wait until it is safe." And so she waited. A yard hen scratching around in the early spring ground for food found the waiting seed and promptly ate it. You see, those of us who refuse to risk and grow get swallowed up by life. **- Patty Hansen**	Hen /hen/ **(n)** gà mái Scratch /skrætʃ/ **(v)** cào, bới, tìm Promptly /ˈprɑːmpt.li/ **(adv)** nhanh chóng, ngay lập tức
It is when we all play safe that we create a world of utmost insecurity. **- Dag Hammarskjold**	



67. TRY SOMETHING DIFFERENT

I'm sitting in a quiet room, in a peaceful little hotel hidden back among the pine trees. It's just past noon, late July, and I am listening to the desperate sounds of a life-or-death struggle going on a few feet away. There's a small fly burning out the last of its short life's energies in a futile attempt to fly through the glass of the windowpane. The whining wings tell the poignant story of the fly's strategy: Try harder. But it's not working. The frenzied effort offers no hope for survival. Ironically, the struggle is part of the trap. The harder the fly tries, the more exhausted it becomes. It's impossible for the fly to try hard enough to succeed at	Life-or-death **(adj)** sống còn, quyết liệt Futile /ˈfjuː.ɾəl/ **(adj)** vô ích Windowpane /ˈwɪn.doʊ.peɪn/ **(n)** ô kính cửa sổ Whining /waɪnɪŋ/ **(adj)** rên rỉ, than van Poignant /ˈpɔɪ.njənt/ **(adj)** sầu thảm, đắng cay

breaking through the glass. Nevertheless, this little insect has staked its life on reaching its goal through raw effort and determination. Finally, the fly is doomed. It dies there on the windowsill. Ten steps away, the door is open. Ten seconds of flying time and this small creature could reach the outside world it seeks. With only a fraction of the effort now being wasted, it could be free of this self-imposed trap. If the fly doesn't get it so locked in on the idea that this particular route and tries another way, it will seek the breakthrough possibly. Trying harder isn't always the solution to achieving more. It may not offer any real promise for getting what you want out of life. Sometimes, in fact, it's a big part of the problem. If you stake your hopes for a breakthrough on trying harder than ever, you may kill your chances for success. **- Price Pritchett**	Frenzied /ˈfren.ziːd/ **(adj)** điên cuồng, cuồng loạn Stake (on) /steɪk/ **(v)** đặt cược Doomed /duːmd/ **(adj)** tiêu tùng, chịu số phận bi đát, thất bại Windowsill /ˈwɪn.doʊ.sɪl/ **(n)** bậu cửa sổ, bệ cửa sổ Self-imposed /ˌself.ɪmˈpoʊzd/ **(adj)** tự đặt cho mình, áp đặt lên bản thân



68. AN AFTERNOON IN THE PARK

There once was a little boy who wanted to meet God. He knew it was a long trip to where God lived, so he packed his suitcase with Twinkies and a six-pack of root beer and he started his journey. When he had gone about three blocks, he met an old woman. She was sitting in the park just staring at some pigeons. The boy sat down next to her and opened his suitcase. He was about to take a drink from his root beer when he noticed that the old lady looked hungry, so he offered her a Twinkie. She gratefully accepted it and smiled at him. Her smile was so pretty that the boy wanted to see it again, so he offered her a root beer. Once again she smiled at him. The boy was delighted!	Root beer /ˈruːt ˌbɪr/ **(n)** đồ uống màu nâu có ga, nồng độ cồn thấp, có hương vị từ rễ của các loại cây khác nhau Delighted /dɪˈlaɪ.ɫɪd/ **(adj)** vui mừng, hài lòng Radiant /ˈreɪ.di.ənt/ **(adj)** rạng rỡ, hớn hở Stun /stʌn/ **(v)** làm sững sờ, kinh ngạc; làm choáng váng

They sat there all afternoon eating and smiling, but they never said a word. As it began to grow dark, the boy realized how tired he was and he got up to leave. He turned around, ran back to the old woman and gave her a hug. She gave him her biggest smile ever. When the boy opened the door to his own house a short time later, his mother was surprised by the look of joy on his face. She asked him, "What did you do today that made you so happy?" He replied, "I had lunch with God. You know what? She's got the most beautiful smile I've ever seen!" Meanwhile, the old woman, also radiant with joy, returned to her home. Her son was stunned by the look of peace on her face and he asked, "Mother, what did you do today that made you so happy?" She replied, "I ate Twinkies in the park with God. You know, he's much younger than I expected." **- Julie A. Manhan**	



69. GANDHI'S SHOES

As Mahatma Gandhi stepped aboard a train one day, one of his shoes slipped off and landed on the track. He was unable to retrieve it as the train was moving. To the amazement of his companions, Gandhi calmly took off his other shoe and threw it back along the track to land close to	Track /træk/ **(n)** đường ray Retrieve /rɪˈtriːv/ **(v)** lấy lại, tìm lại được

the first. Asked by a fellow passenger why he did so, Gandhi smiled. "The poor man who finds the shoe lying on the track," he replied, "will now have a pair he can use." **- Source Unknown**	



70. WHAT GOES AROUND COMES AROUND

When I was working as a disc jockey in Columbus, Ohio, I used to stop at a local hospital on my way home. I would walk into different people's rooms and read Scripture to them or talk to them. It was a way of forgetting about my problems and being thankful to God. It made a difference in the lives of those I visited. One time, it literally saved my life. One night, I came home at about two o'clock in the morning. As I began to open my door, a man came out from behind the side of my house and said. "Are you Les Brown?" I said "Yes, sir." He said, "I was sent here to carry out a contract on you." "Me? Why?" I asked. He said, "Well, there's a promoter that's very upset about the money you cost him when you said that the entertainers who were coming to town were not the original real group." "Are you going to do something to me?" I asked.	Disc jockey /ˈdɪsk ˌdʒɑː.ki/ **(n)** = DJ Scripture /ˈskrɪp.tʃər/ **(n)** Kinh thánh (nói chung) Carry out **(ph.v)** thực hiện, tiến hành Promoter /prəˈmoʊ.ţər/ **(n)** người tài trợ, người tổ chức Penitentiary /ˌpen.ɪˈten.ʃər.i/ **(n)** nhà lao, trại cải tạo

He said, "No - I'll tell you why. My mother was in Grant Hospital and she wrote me about how you came in one day and sat down and talked to her and read Scripture to her. She was so impressed that this morning disc jockey, who didn't know her, came in and did that. She wrote me about you when I was in the Ohio penitentiary. I was impressed with that and I've always wanted to meet you. When I heard the word out on the street that somebody wanted to knock you off," he said, "I told them about you, about thoughts of my mother and others patients in the hospital. After listening to me, they accepted to leave out everything and let you peaceful." **- Les Brown**	



71. ANGEL WITH A RED HAT

I was scared as I sat in the coffee shop. Tomorrow I would have spinal surgery. The risk was high, but my faith was strong. I prayed, "Oh, heavenly Father, in my time of trial, send me an angel." As I looked up, preparing to leave, I saw an elderly lady walking very slowly to the register. I stood by her, admiring her flair for fashion - a bright paisley dress of red and purple, a scarf, a brooch, and a brilliant scarlet hat. I said, "Excuse me, madam. I just must say what a beautiful woman you are." She friendly clasped my hand and said, "My child, bless you, for you see, I have an artificial arm and a plate in the other, and my leg is not my own. It takes me quite some time to get dressed. I do my best, but as years go by, people don't seem to think it matters. You've made me feel so special today. May the Lord watch over and bless you." As she walked away, she had touched my soul in such away that I knew she could have only been the angel. **- Tami S. Fox**	Flair /fler/ **(n)** sự tinh tế Paisley /ˈpeɪz.li/ **(adj)** họa tiết có những đường cong hình cánh hoa (trên vải) Brooch /broʊtʃ/ **(n)** trâm (gài đầu) / ghim hoa (cài cổ áo) Scarlet /ˈskɑːr.lət/ **(adj)** đỏ tươi Clasp /klæsp/ **(v)** nắm chặt, siết chặt Plate /pleɪt/ **(n)** thanh nẹp (bằng kim loại) giúp giữ các mảnh xương gãy lại với nhau.

Faith is the evidence of things not seen. **- The Bible**	



72. A SMALL BOY AND A STAR

A small boy looked at a star and began to weep And the star said, Boy why are you weeping? And the boy said, You are so far away. I will never be able to touch you. And the star answered, Boy if I were not already in your heart, you would not be able to see me. **- John Magliola**	Weep /wiːp/ **(v)** khóc, nhỏ nước mắt



73. THE LIFE STATION

Tucked away in our subconscious is an idyllic vision. We are traveling by train - out the windows, we drink in the passing scenes of children waving at a crossing, cattle grazing on a distant hillside, row upon row of corn and wheat, flatlands and valleys, mountains and rolling hillsides and city skylines. But uppermost in our minds is the final destination. On a certain day, we will pull into the station. Bands will be playing and flags waving. Once we get there, our dreams will come true and the pieces of our lives will fit together like a completed jigsaw puzzle. Restlessly we pace the aisles, damning the minutes - waiting, waiting, waiting for the station. "When we reach the station, that will be it!" we cry. "When I'm 18." "When I buy a new 450 SL Mercedes Benz!" "When I put the last kid through college." "When I have paid off the mortgage!" "When I get a promotion." "When I reach retirement, I shall live happily ever after!" Sooner or later, we realize there is no station, no one place to arrive. The true joy of life is the trip. The station is only a dream. It constantly outdistances us. "Relish the moment" is a good motto, especially when coupled with Psalm 118:24: "This is the day which the Lord hath made; we will rejoice and be glad in it." It isn't the burdens of today that drive men mad. It is the regrets over yesterday and the fear of tomorrow. Regret and fear are twin thieves who rob us of today. So stop pacing the aisles and counting the miles. Instead, climb more mountains, eat more ice cream, go barefoot more often, swim more rivers, watch more sunsets, laugh more, cry less. Life must be lived as we go along. The station will come soon enough. **- Robert J. Hastings**	Tuck away /tʌk/ **(ph.v)** giấu kín, ẩn sâu Idyllic /aɪˈdɪl.ɪk/ **(adj)** bình dị, thôn dã Graze /greɪz/ **(v)** ăn cỏ Rolling hillsides /ˈroʊ.lɪŋ/ **(adj)** /ˈhɪl.saɪd/ **(n)** những sườn đồi dâng lên cuồn cuộn / trập trùng Jigsaw puzzle /ˈdʒɪg.sɑː ˌpʌz.əl/ **(n)** trò chơi ghép hình Restlessly /ˈrest.ləs.li/ **(adv)** bồn chồn, không yên Mortgage /ˈmɔːr.gɪdʒ/ **(n)** tiền thế chấp Constantly /ˈkɑːn.stənt.li/ **(adv)** liên tục, luôn luôn Outdistance /ˌaʊtˈdɪs.təns/ **(v)** vượt xa Relish /ˈrel.ɪʃ/ **(v)** tận hưởng, ưa thích, thích thú Motto /ˈmɑː.ţoʊ/ **(n)** phương châm, khẩu hiệu Hath /hæθ/ = has (từ cổ) Rejoice /rɪˈdʒɔɪs/ **(v)** vui mừng, hoan hỉ, hân hoan Barefoot /ˈber.fʊt/ **(adv)** chân trần
Never regret yesterday, life is in you today and you will make your tomorrow. **- L. Ron Hubbard**	